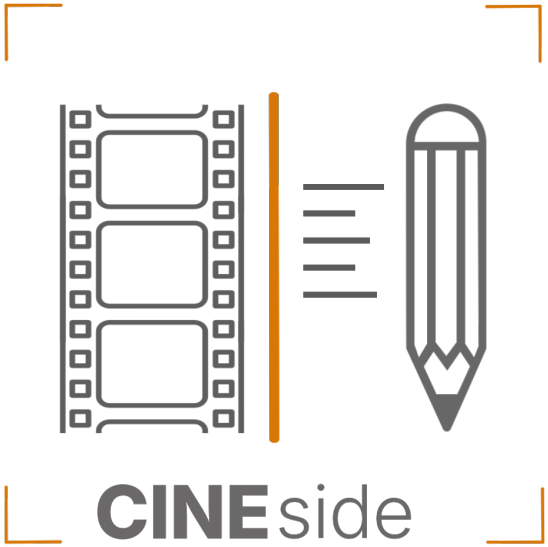


User Manual

Version 1.8 · macOS & iPad

Shot planning for cinematographers and directors

Contents

1 Overview 3
1.1 Working Modes 3
1.2 Demo Mode and License 4
1.3 Interface Layout 5
1.4 File Formats 7
1.5 Getting CINEside 7

2 Screenplay 8
2.1 Importing a Screenplay 8
2.2 Importing a Revised Screenplay 10
2.3 Editing Script Text 12
2.4 Script Version 12
2.5 Search 12
2.6 Filter 12

3 Scenes 13
3.1 Scene Header Fields 13
3.2 Scene Flags 16
3.3 Location Panel 16
3.4 Tags & References 17
3.5 Additional Crew (Cinematographer mode) 17
3.6 Additional Equipment (Cinematographer mode) 17
3.7 My Notes 17
3.8 Prep Checklist 18
3.9 Scene Actions (top right of each scene) 18
3.10 Scene Manager 20
3.11 Part Divide 20
3.12 Marking Scenes as Shot 21

4 Shots 22
4.1 Creating a Shot 22
4.2 Shot Fields 23
4.3 Shot Variants 25
4.4 Shot Labels 25
4.5 Anchoring Shots to the Script 26
4.6 Reading the script column 26
4.7 Shot Navigation 27
4.8 Undo 27

5 Visual References 28
5.1 Shot Photos 28
5.2 Scene-Level References 28
5.3 Anchors on Floorplans & Lighting Plans 29
5.4 Location-Level References 34
5.5 Promote a Photo to a Plan 34
5.6 Scene Board 35
5.7 Sketch Pad (iPad only) 36

6 Notes & Annotations 37
6.1 Discuss With 37
6.2 Script Annotations 38
6.3 My Notes 38
6.4 CONNECT Notes 38

7 Schedule 39
7.1 Phase 1 - Assigning Scenes to Days 39
7.2 Phase 2 - Ordering Shots 41
7.3 Schedule Export 41

8 Export 43
8.1 Shots & Script (Facing Pages) 43
8.2 Shot List Only 43
8.3 Scene List 44
8.4 Location Dossier 44
8.5 Reference Sheets 45
8.6 Prep Checklist 45
8.7 iPad / Tablet Format 45
8.8 Include Toggles 46
8.9 Filter 46
8.10 Scene Selection 46
8.11 Export Note 47
8.12 Save & Share 47

9 CINEside CONNECT 48
9.1 Exporting to CONNECT 48
9.2 Collaborator's Workflow (in CINEside CONNECT) 48
9.3 Importing Notes 48
9.4 CONNECT works in both directions 48

10 Sharing a Project 50
10.1 Full → send to iPad/ Mac 50
10.2 For Director 50
10.3 For Cinematographer 50
10.4 Receiving a Share Package 50

11 Preferences 51
11.1 Automatic Updates 51
11.2 Automatic Backups 52
11.3 Restoring a Backup 52
11.4 License 52

12 Saving & Project Management 55
12.1 Saving 55
12.2 Recent Projects 55
12.3 Closing a Project 56

13 Keyboard Shortcuts 56

14 CINEside CONNECT 57
14.1 Opening a Package 57
14.2 Navigating 57
14.3 Adding Notes 57
14.4 Exporting 58
14.5 Limitations 58

15 File Format Reference 59

16 Support 59

1 Overview

CINEside is an application for planning narrative film productions, available for Mac and iPad. It keeps your screenplay, shot list, visual references, and department notes in one place - completely offline, with no cloud connection required.
The interface is built around the screenplay. Your script stays on the right; shots and notes go on the left. Everything is anchored to the scene it belongs to.

On iPad: CINEside works the same way as on Mac - the same layout, shots, scenes, references, schedule, and PDF exports. A few things differ: how you unlock the full version (1.2), where projects are stored and reopened (1.4, 12), adding photos (5.1), how a reference photo is promoted to a plan (5.5), the Reading Lock button (1.3), updates via the App Store (11.1), the Sketch Pad for Apple Pencil drawings (5.7), and the Scene Board, which is Mac-only (5.6). Each of these is flagged with an On iPad note in the relevant section.

1.1 Working Modes

Switching between modes never deletes data - fields hidden in one mode remain in the project and reappear when you switch back. Which department-specific notes end up in a share package or a CONNECT file is handled separately (see 6.3, 9, 10).

Cinematographer	Default mode. Shows lighting plans, sun position diagrams, crew and equipment notes, and department discussions addressed to Director, 1st AD, Production, Gaffer, Camera Department, Key Grip, Dolly Grip, Costume, Make Up/ Hair, Art Department.
Director	Hides the DP-specific fields (lighting plans, sun position diagrams, crew and equipment notes) and adds discussion notes addressed to Screenwriter, Casting, Actor, Editor, and Composer. Location, visual references, and shot planning remain fully available.

1.2 Demo Mode and License

CINEside starts in Demo Mode. All core features are available except three: saving projects as .cnsd files, exporting to CONNECT, and sharing a project as .cnsf. PDF exports work but are watermarked, and your work isn't kept after you quit.

Sample project. The first time you continue in Demo Mode, CINEside opens a short sample project – three scenes with a café floorplan and one shot already placed on it – so you can try shot planning right away, without a screenplay of your own. If you close it, you can reopen it anytime from the empty start screen with Open sample project; each time you get a fresh copy. To try the screenplay import, use your own script or download the sample screenplay (PDF) from cineside.app under Getting Started.

How you unlock the full version depends on where you got CINEside:

- Mac App Store (iPad and Mac): tap Buy Full Version and complete the purchase through the App Store. The button shows the price set by Apple for your country, including local tax. One purchase covers both platforms - on your other device, tap Restore Purchases to unlock it at no extra cost. CINEside on the App Store: https://apps.apple.com/app/cineside-shot-list-script/id6791491272

- Existing customers with a license key (purchased before the App Store release): your license keeps working on all platforms - no second purchase. In the direct-download version on Mac, click Activate License in the toolbar and enter your key; the app switches immediately, no restart required. In the App Store version - Mac or iPad - enter the e-mail you used for the purchase and your license key as the password, then tap Sign In.

One license is for your personal use - up to three devices at once, across Mac and iPad. Updates are free. If you're replacing a device, use Preferences → License → Deactivate This Device first to free up a slot (see 11.4).

Unlocking enables saving, CONNECT export, and project sharing, and removes the watermark from PDF exports.

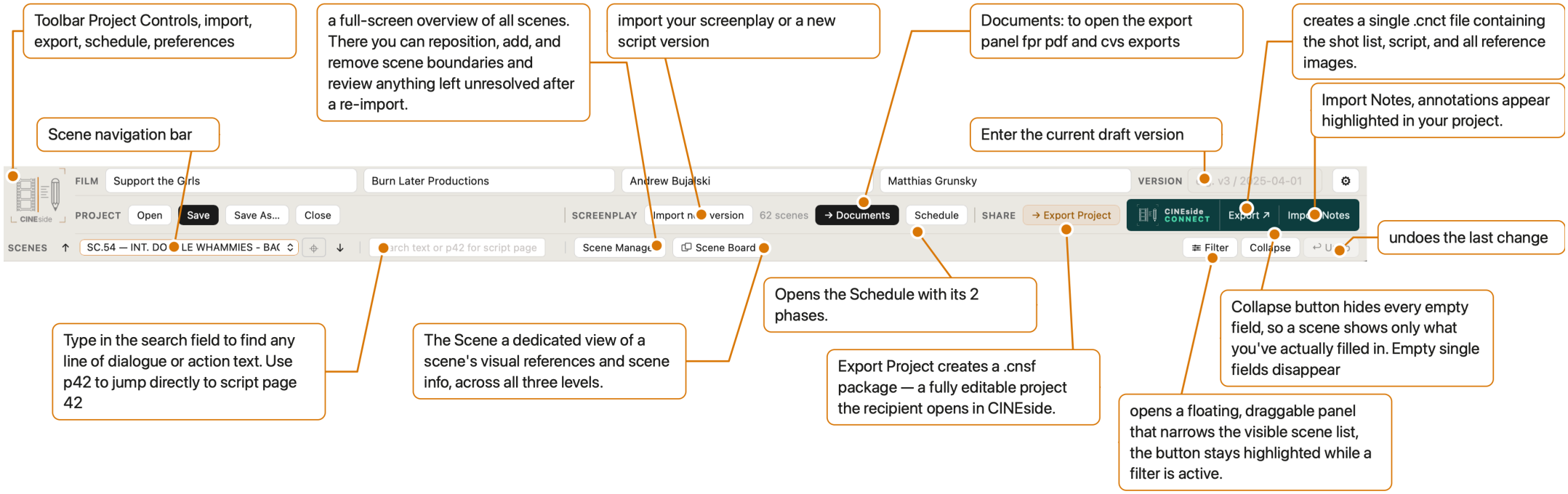
1.3 Interface Layout

Always visible:

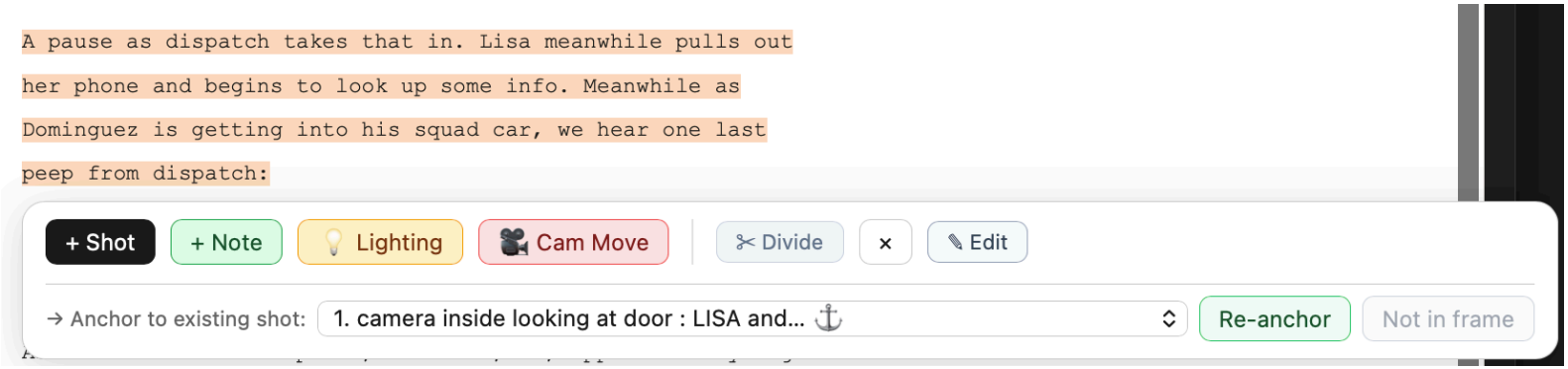
Toolbar (top)	Project controls, import, export, schedule, and preferences.
Scene navigation bar	A thin toolbar above the scene area for jumping between scenes: arrow buttons, a dropdown to jump to any scene, and a search field for script text and page numbers.
Scene area	The main working area below, showing every scene in script order, one after another. Each scene has a header (scene number, slug, day/night, pages) and a body with two columns: shots and notes on the left, script on the right.
Script column	The script column shows the screenplay with anchored shots drawn as coloured lines. A number row at the top lists the shots of the current scene.
Collapse /Reading Mode)	The Collapse button in the toolbar hides every empty field, so a scene shows only what you've actually filled in. Empty single fields disappear; a section whose fields are all empty disappears together with its heading; the Location panel collapses entirely when nothing has been entered for that location. Location / Motif and Sub-Location always stay visible. Your scroll position is kept when you toggle, and the setting is remembered between sessions. Click again (the button now reads Collapsed) to show all fields.
Lock (only on iPad)	The same Collapse behaviour is tied to the Lock button - locking the project for reading hides empty fields and empty sections the same way. One button controls both reading lock and collapse. A READING - locked badge appears while it's on; tap Locked to unlock.

Contextual - appear only when relevant:

Anchor popup	The anchor popup appears when you select text in the script. Its header names the scene the selection belongs to.
Next Note button (bottom right)	Appears only when unreviewed CONNECT notes are pending. Lets you step through them one by one.



The Anchor popup appears when text is selected in the script. Use it to create new shots or annotations anchored to the selected passage, to edit the text in the screenplay, or to divide a scene into parts:



1.4 File Formats

All four file formats are registered on macOS - double-clicking any of them opens the correct application automatically.

.cnsd 	Your CINEside project. A folder on your Mac containing the project file, a photos/ subfolder with all reference images, and a .backups/ subfolder.
On iPad:	Projects live in a fixed CINEside Projects folder inside the app's own storage, and are reopened from the recent projects list rather than the Files app (opening a project through Files would give you a copy without its photos). The file picker on iPad is for importing .cnsf share packages.
.cnct 	CONNECT package for collaboration. Read-only - your collaborator can annotate but not edit. Created via CONNECT → Export ↗.
.cnsn 	Notes file returned by a collaborator from CINEside CONNECT. Contains only their annotations. Import by double-clicking.
.cnsf 	Share package for handing off a fully editable project. See section 10 and 15 for details.

1.5 Getting CINEside

CINEside runs on Mac and iPad. One App Store purchase covers both: https://apps.apple.com/app/cineside-shot-list-script/id6791491272

CINEside CONNECT, the free companion app for directors and crew, is also available for Mac and iPad: https://apps.apple.com/app/cineside-connect/id6793694166

See 1.2 Demo Mode and License for unlocking the full version and for existing license keys.

Both editions open the same project files.

2 Screenplay

2.1 Importing a Screenplay

Click Import PDF in the Toolbar and select your screenplay. After import, CINEside automatically detects all scene headings and creates a scene for each one. The script text appears in the right column of each scene.

Reviewing Uncertain Scenes
If the same scene appears to occur twice in a row - usually because it continues across a page break - CINEside does not guess. Instead, each uncertain case is presented individually in a review step: you decide whether it is the same scene (discard the duplicate) or a genuinely different scene (restore it), and the outcome is shown immediately at the card. For harder cases, an option lets you view both relevant script pages side by side, with independent navigation for each page. Any decision can be revisited before finishing, and a summary is shown before the result is applied.
Once detection finishes, the Scene Manager opens automatically so you can review, reorder, or adjust scene boundaries before continuing - see 3.10.

No Scenes Detected
If CINEside cannot extract any scene headings at all - for example with non-standard formats - a Mark scenes manually button appears instead. This opens a simpler line-by-line view: click any line to mark it as a scene heading, click again to unmark it.

Supported screenplay languages
CINEside cannot know every screenplay format in the world, but it reads scene headings in English, German, French, Spanish, Italian, Portuguese, Swedish, Norwegian and Danish. It recognises INT./EXT. before or after the location, slash forms such as INNEN/AUSSEN or INT/DÍA, and numbered headings with or without INT/EXT. A heading without INT/EXT is shown as written.
Time-of-day words appear as they are in the script. Scandinavian, Spanish, Italian and Portuguese terms (e.g. DAG, NATT, DÍA, NOCHE, GIORNO, NOTTE, NOITE) are translated in the shot list, and FORTS., CONTINÚA or SEGUE are read as CONTINUOUS.
Scenes marked OMITTED (GESTRICHEN or ENTFÄLLT in German scripts) keep their number and are marked as deleted, so the numbering of the other scenes stays intact. If a scene number occurs twice, the Scene Manager flags it (“No. 32 also on p. 37”).

Scene Manager

12 scenes Cancel Done →

SCRIPT

▶ SCENE STARTS

1 LOTTIE'S BEDROOM INT MORNING

LOTTIE is in bed with JAMES, a morning after a night to remember.

Lottie grinning and gazing deep into James' eyes.

James grinning in turn and holding her stare. Neither wants to break the gaze. And now they're almost trying to goad each other into laughing, into exploding with happiness.

Finally Lottie breaks and laughs.

JAMES

I love your laugh. I love your laugh.

LOTTIE

I love your face, my God...And I've seen a lot of faces!

JAMES

Have you?

SCENES

SC.1 LOTTIE'S BEDROOM
INT · MORNING 391 lines

SC.2 GARDEN CAFE
EXT · DAY 415 lines

SC.3 HIGH SCHOOL - CLASSROOM
INT · DAY 405 lines

SC.4 ZOOM CALL
INT/EXT · DAY 1 line

SC.5 SAM'S HOUSE - PORCH DECK
EXT · DAY 1 line

SC.6 SETH'S HOUSE - KITCHEN
INT · DAY 414 lines

SC.7 SETH'S BEDROOM
INT · NIGHT 327 lines

SC.8 SETH'S HOUSE - KITCHEN
INT · NIGHT 64 lines

SC.9 SETH'S BATHROOM
INT · NIGHT 18 lines

SC.10 SETH'S KITCHEN
INT · NIGHT 56 lines

SC.11 SETH'S BEDROOM
INT · NIGHT 73 lines

SC.12 BAR AND GRILL
INT · NIGHT 392 lines

2.2 Importing a Revised Screenplay

When a new draft arrives, click Import new version. CINEside offers two modes:

Full Script	Use for a complete new draft. CINEside updates all script text while keeping your shots, notes, anchors, and references intact.
Revisions Only	Use for partial updates when only specific pages have changed.

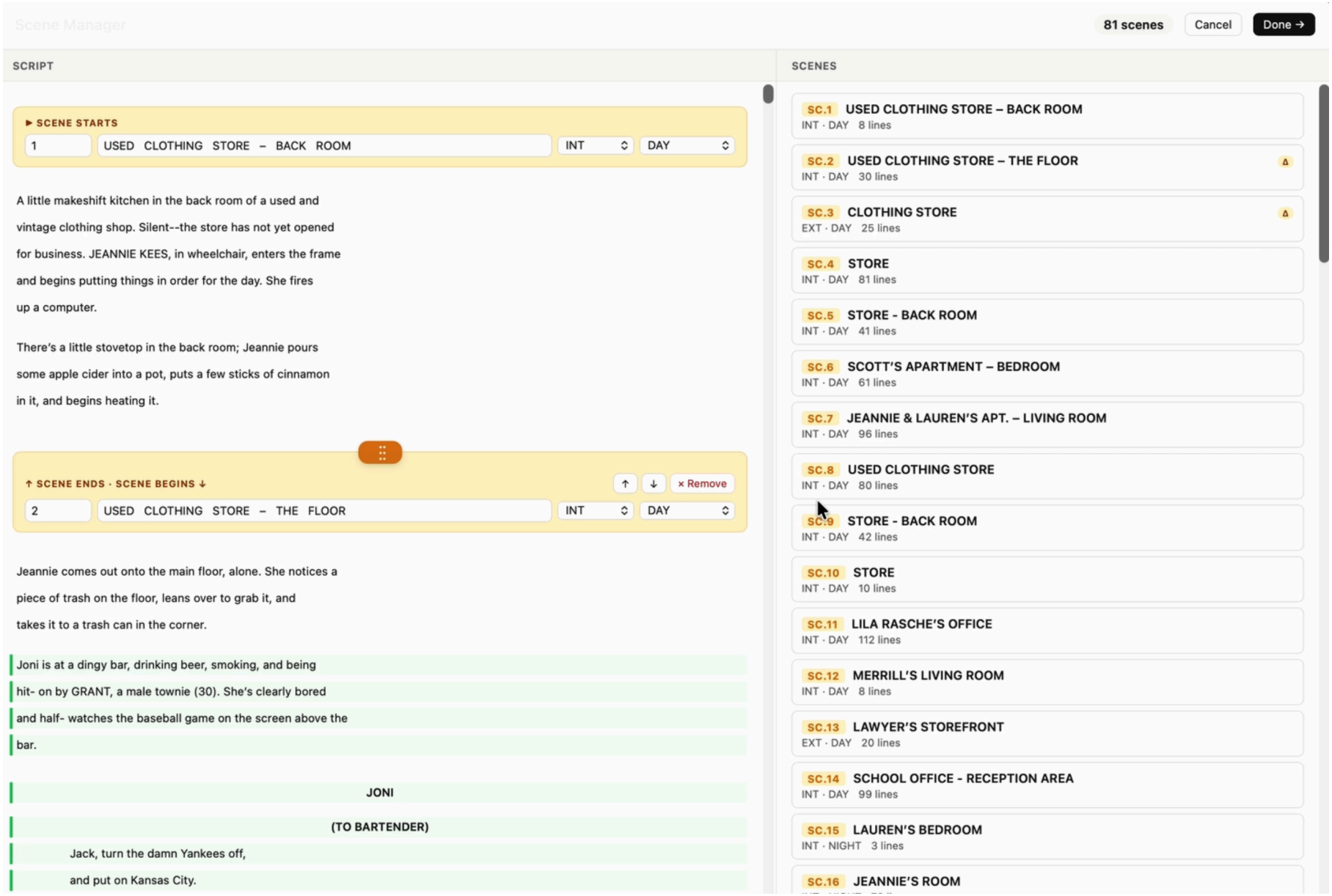
CINEside matches new scenes against existing ones by scene number, slug line, and text content. Confident matches keep all attached shots, notes, photos, and anchors. Less certain matches go through the same review step described in 2.1. After matching, the Scene Manager opens automatically once more so you can review the merged result before continuing.

Scene Heading Corrections Are Preserved
If you've corrected a scene's heading directly in Scene Manager - for example fixing a location the director labeled inconsistently - that correction is now kept across future re-imports. Only the fields you haven't manually corrected continue to update from the new draft; scene numbering and page ranges always keep following the script.

What a re-import keeps
Shots, camera moves and script notes stay on their script lines and in the correct part, even when lines are added or removed around them. If a part boundary's line is removed, the boundary moves to the next remaining line and is flagged for review. Scenes you've marked as deleted keep their shots and notes. CONNECT notes stay attached to their script line; if that line changed, the note moves into the scene's notes as "[From CONNECT, script line changed] ...". A manually arranged shot order is preserved.

Orphaned Anchors, Boundaries, and Camera Moves
If a shot's anchor, a camera move, a note, or a part boundary (see 3.11, splitting a scene into parts) can no longer be matched - because the passage no longer exists in the new draft - it's flagged with an out of sync warning and a Re-anchor button appears in its place. Click it, select the new text in the script, and the link is restored. When re-anchoring, the previously anchored script text is shown as a read-only preview rather than an editable box - select the new script range you want the shot to cover.
After a re-import, a small notice appears in the bottom-right corner showing how many such items still need attention (N issues still out of sync). Click Jump to next to go straight to each one in turn, fix it, and the notice counts down automatically until none remain. Dismiss it any time with the ✕ - it reappears after the next re-import if new issues come up.

Reviewing What Changed
Scenes whose script text changed are marked Δ changed and listed in a N scenes changed by last import banner, with arrows to step through them one at a time - this opens Scene Manager and shows the actual added/removed text for each affected scene.


Scene Manager
81 scenes
Cancel
Done →
SCRIPT
SCENES
▶ SCENE STARTS
1
USED CLOTHING STORE – BACK ROOM
INT
DAY
A little makeshift kitchen in the back room of a used and vintage clothing shop. Silent--the store has not yet opened for business. JEANNIE KEES, in wheelchair, enters the frame and begins putting things in order for the day. She fires up a computer.
There's a little stovetop in the back room; Jeannie pours some apple cider into a pot, puts a few sticks of cinnamon in it, and begins heating it.
↑ SCENE ENDS · SCENE BEGINS ↓
× Remove
2
USED CLOTHING STORE – THE FLOOR
INT
DAY
Jeannie comes out onto the main floor, alone. She notices a piece of trash on the floor, leans over to grab it, and takes it to a trash can in the corner.
Joni is at a dingy bar, drinking beer, smoking, and being hit- on by GRANT, a male townie (30). She's clearly bored and half- watches the baseball game on the screen above the bar.
JONI
(TO BARTENDER)
Jack, turn the damn Yankees off, and put on Kansas City.
SC.1 USED CLOTHING STORE – BACK ROOM
INT · DAY 8 lines
SC.2 USED CLOTHING STORE – THE FLOOR
INT · DAY 30 lines
SC.3 CLOTHING STORE
EXT · DAY 25 lines
SC.4 STORE
INT · DAY 81 lines
SC.5 STORE - BACK ROOM
INT · DAY 41 lines
SC.6 SCOTT'S APARTMENT – BEDROOM
INT · DAY 61 lines
SC.7 JEANNIE & LAUREN'S APT. – LIVING ROOM
INT · DAY 96 lines
SC.8 USED CLOTHING STORE
INT · DAY 80 lines
SC.9 STORE - BACK ROOM
INT · DAY 42 lines
SC.10 STORE
INT · DAY 10 lines
SC.11 LILA RASCHE'S OFFICE
INT · DAY 112 lines
SC.12 MERRILL'S LIVING ROOM
INT · DAY 8 lines
SC.13 LAWYER'S STOREFRONT
EXT · DAY 20 lines
SC.14 SCHOOL OFFICE - RECEPTION AREA
INT · DAY 99 lines
SC.15 LAUREN'S BEDROOM
INT · NIGHT 3 lines
SC.16 JEANNIE'S ROOM

2.3 Editing Script Text

Once you're in the main CINEside view - after import and any review in the Scene Manager - select text in the script and click ✎ Edit in the anchor popup to correct OCR errors or typos. This does not affect the original PDF.

2.4 Script Version

Enter the current draft version in the Version field in the toolbar (e.g. "v3 / 2025-04-01"). This appears on the title page of all exported PDFs.

2.5 Search

Type in the search field in the navigation bar to find any line of dialogue or action text. The search also covers your shot and scene data - locations, shot descriptions, notes, lens choices, and more. Results follow the scene order. Use p42 to jump directly to script page 42.
Press Enter (or the ↑ ↓ buttons next to the field) to step through results, Shift+Enter to go back. A match in the script is highlighted; a match in a field is shown with a frame around the field. The cursor stays in the search field, so pressing Enter never changes the text of a field.
When a scene filter is active (2.6), hidden scenes are skipped and counted - for example "3/12 + 4 hidden by filter".

On iPad: while you type, the screen stays still and only the counter updates. Tap the search key to close the keyboard and jump to the first result, then use ↑ ↓ to step through. The ✕ inside the field clears the search.

2.6 Filter

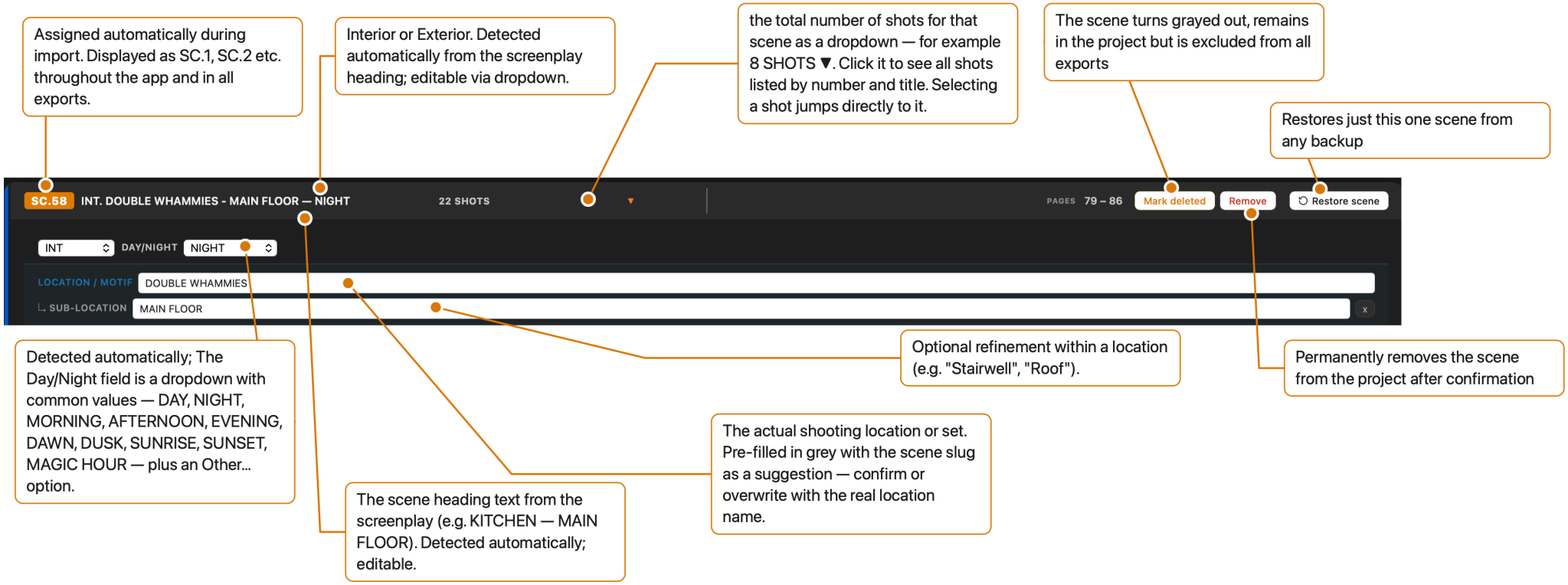
The Filter button in the toolbar opens a floating, draggable panel that narrows the visible scene list. A live counter ("N of M") shows how many scenes match, and the button stays highlighted while a filter is active. Clear filter shows all scenes again.
Location: the first two rows narrow the script to one location. The dropdown lists every location in the project - taken from the Location field, or from the slug where no location is set - with its scene count. If the chosen location has sub-locations, a second dropdown appears to go one level deeper, or to show only the scenes of that location without a sub-location. Choosing a different location resets the sub-location. Locations that differ only in capitalisation count as one (see 8.4).

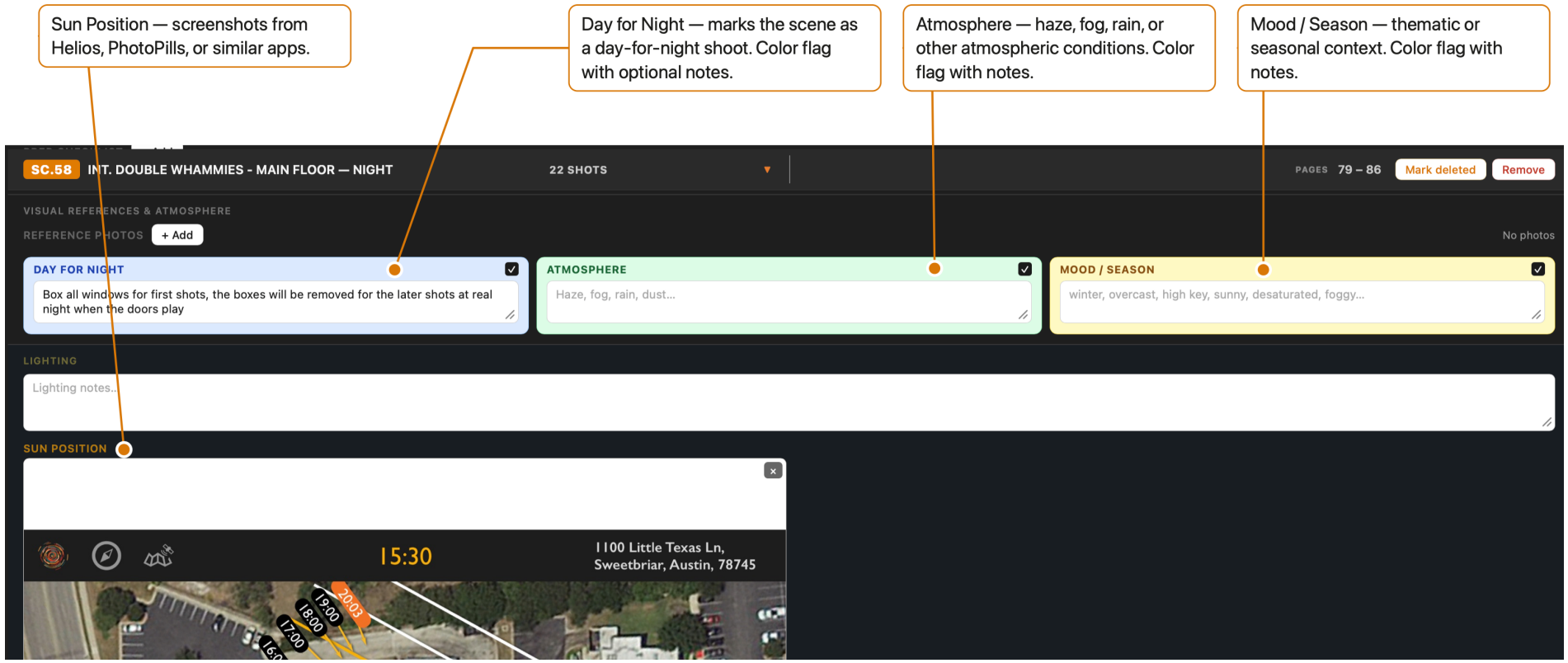
The location criterion is not remembered between sessions, since its values belong to the open project. All other criteria are remembered and apply as soon as CINEside starts or a project is opened. First-level criteria: INT/EXT and Day/Night. Further criteria filter by shot content and scene data - Support (Steadicam, Camera Car, Drone), VFX/SFX, Unit (2nd, Splinter, Pre-Shoot), Addt'l Equipment (Camera, Lighting, Grip, Cam Support), Day for Night, and Addt'l Crew. Status shows All scenes, only the Remaining scenes, or only the Wrapped ones - the scenes you've marked as shot with the dog-ear (see 3.12). With Remaining active, a scene you mark as shot disappears from view right away, so the list shrinks as you work through the shoot. A scene matches an additive criterion when at least one of its shots (or its scene-level data) meets it. All active criteria combine - a scene must match every one to remain visible. Scenes marked as deleted follow the filter like any other scene but are not counted.

3 Scenes

3.1 Scene Header Fields

Scene Number	Assigned automatically during import. Displayed as SC.1, SC.2 etc. throughout the app and in all exports.
INT / EXT	Interior or Exterior. Detected automatically from the screenplay heading; editable via dropdown.
Slug / Title	The scene heading text from the screenplay (e.g. KITCHEN - MAIN FLOOR). Detected automatically; editable.
Day / Night	Time of day. Detected automatically; The Day/Night field is a dropdown with common values - DAY, NIGHT, MORNING, AFTERNOON, EVENING, DAWN, DUSK, SUNRISE, SUNSET, MAGIC HOUR - plus an Other… option. Choose Other… to type a free-text value ("3 AM", "Blue Hour", "Continuous"). Any free-text value you use anywhere in the project is offered automatically as a dropdown option in every scene, and disappears again once no scene uses it. Imported values from the screenplay are kept as written; refine them here in the app.
Pages	Script page range for this scene (e.g. 12–13½). Detected automatically from the imported screenplay. Display-only in the scene card.
Location / Motif	The actual shooting location or set. Pre-filled in grey with the scene slug as a suggestion - confirm or overwrite with the real location name. Scenes with identical location names share the same location notes, photos, and floorplans. As you type, CINEside suggests matching names already used in the project, helping avoid accidental near-duplicates from typos or incomplete entries.
Sub-location	Optional refinement within a location (e.g. "Stairwell", "Roof"). Suggestions are limited to sub-locations already used within that same location, so names stay consistent without pulling in unrelated results from other locations.


Assigned automatically during import. Displayed as SC.1, SC.2 etc. throughout the app and in all exports.
Interior or Exterior. Detected automatically from the screenplay heading; editable via dropdown.
the total number of shots for that scene as a dropdown — for example 8 SHOTS ▼. Click it to see all shots listed by number and title. Selecting a shot jumps directly to it.
The scene turns grayed out, remains in the project but is excluded from all exports
Restores just this one scene from any backup
SC.58
INT. DOUBLE WHAMMIES - MAIN FLOOR — NIGHT
22 SHOTS
PAGES 79 – 86
Mark deleted
Remove
Restore scene
INT
DAY/NIGHT
NIGHT
LOCATION / MOTIF
DOUBLE WHAMMIES
SUB-LOCATION
MAIN FLOOR
Detected automatically; The Day/Night field is a dropdown with common values — DAY, NIGHT, MORNING, AFTERNOON, EVENING, DAWN, DUSK, SUNRISE, SUNSET, MAGIC HOUR — plus an Other... option.
Optional refinement within a location (e.g. "Stairwell", "Roof").
Permanently removes the scene from the project after confirmation
The actual shooting location or set. Pre-filled in grey with the scene slug as a suggestion — confirm or overwrite with the real location name.
The scene heading text from the screenplay (e.g. KITCHEN — MAIN FLOOR). Detected automatically; editable.


Sun Position — screenshots from Helios, PhotoPills, or similar apps.
Day for Night — marks the scene as a day-for-night shoot. Color flag with optional notes.
Atmosphere — haze, fog, rain, or other atmospheric conditions. Color flag with notes.
Mood / Season — thematic or seasonal context. Color flag with notes.
SC.58
INT. DOUBLE WHAMMIES - MAIN FLOOR — NIGHT
22 SHOTS
PAGES 79 – 86
Mark deleted
Remove
VISUAL REFERENCES & ATMOSPHERE
REFERENCE PHOTOS
+ Add
No photos
DAY FOR NIGHT
Box all windows for first shots, the boxes will be removed for the later shots at real night when the doors play
ATMOSPHERE
Haze, fog, rain, dust...
MOOD / SEASON
winter, overcast, high key, sunny, desaturated, foggy...
LIGHTING
Lighting notes...
SUN POSITION
15:30
1100 Little Texas Ln,
Sweetbriar, Austin, 78745
2003
19:00
18:00
17:00

3.2 Scene Flags

Day for Night	Marks the scene as a day-for-night shoot. Color flag with optional notes.
Atmosphere	Haze, fog, rain, or other atmospheric conditions. Color flag with notes.
Mood / Season	Thematic or seasonal context. Color flag with notes.

NOTE: Section 3.3 covers information shared across all scenes at a location. Sections 3.4 onward cover information specific to this one scene.

3.3 Location Panel

Once a Location / Motif name is confirmed, a blue Location panel appears below the scene header. This panel is shared across all scenes at the same location - add notes, reference photos, floor plans, and on-site checklist items in one place, available everywhere this location is used.

Scenes are grouped by location name exactly as entered - use consistent spelling across all scenes at the same location.
When you rename a location, CINEside asks you to confirm before applying the change. A simple rename updates every scene using that name and keeps all notes and photos attached. If other scenes still use the same name but haven't been assigned any location data yet, CINEside asks whether the rename should apply to all of them or just this scene. If the new name matches an existing location that already has its own data, CINEside warns you before merging the two - no data is deleted in either case. The location block shows which name the scenes are grouped by, with a warning when the match comes from the scene heading because no location field has been set.

Location Notes	Free-text notes about the location- for example: "ND all windows", "remove all benches before shoot", "no parked cars in front of windows".
Location Photos	Reference images of the location. Shared across all scenes here. Add via the + button or drag from Finder. Each photo can have a caption.
Floorplan	Floor plan images for this location. Shared across all scenes here. Can also be shown in the Scene Board.
To Check at Location	A shared checklist per location for things to verify on site (check angles, ceiling heights, take specific stills…). Items appear in every scene at the same location. Checked items are hidden from the Location Dossier PDF.
Dossier ↗	Jumps directly to the Location Dossier export for this location.

3.4 Tags & References

Scene Tags
Group scenes by storyline, time period, dream sequence, technical category, or any recurring theme.
Tags are project-wide - create a tag once, assign it to any number of scenes.
Click Add / Edit next to Tags. A modal lets you create a new tag with a custom color, assign an existing tag, or edit a tag you've already made.
Renaming a tag or changing its color updates it everywhere it's used - across every scene, in CINEside CONNECT, and in PDF exports.
You can also delete a tag, which removes it from all scenes at once. Tags appear as colored stripes along the left edge of each scene - in CINEside, in CINEside CONNECT, and in exported PDFs (enable the Tags toggle in the export panel).

Typical uses:
- Storylines in parallel narratives ("Anne", "Peter", "Both")
- Time periods ("1890s", "Present Day")
- Dream sequences, flashbacks, fantasy sequences
- color themes, phases a character goes through
- technical set ups

References
Group reference URLs relevant to a scene - test shoots, reference films, location websites. Click + Add to add a link.

3.5 Additional Crew (Cinematographer mode)

Add extra crew members specific to this scene. Each entry has a description, a quantity, and a category: Camera, Cam Support / Dolly, Lighting, or Grip. As you type a name, CINEside suggests names already used elsewhere in the project. Appears in the Addt'l Crew Sheet export, the Shot List and Schedule PDF.

3.6 Additional Equipment (Cinematographer mode)

Add special equipment requirements specific to this scene. Each entry has a description, a quantity, and a category: Camera, Cam Support / Dolly, Lighting, or Grip. Suggestions from previously entered equipment appear as you type. Can be exported as a separate reference sheet filtered by category.

3.7 My Notes

Every scene has a private My Notes field. Excluded from all exports unless the My Notes toggle is explicitly enabled.

3.8 Prep Checklist

A per-scene checklist for things you need to prepare or remember before the shoot. Located below My Notes. Like My Notes, this is for you only - it never appears in regular exports or CONNECT packages.
Open items can be exported as a dedicated PDF via the Prep Checklist tab in the export dialog.

3.9 Scene Actions (top right of each scene)

Mark as Deleted	The scene turns grayed out, remains in the project but is excluded from all exports and the Schedule. Can be undone at any time by clicking Mark as Active.
Remove	Permanently removes the scene from the project after confirmation. This cannot be undone (except immediately via the Undo button).
Restore Scene	Restores just this one scene from any backup - without touching the rest of the project. Click it to see every restore point (recent saves, hourly and daily anchors, pre-import copies), each with a short summary of that version: INT/EXT, slug line, number of shots, notes, floor plan and lighting plan. Pick the version you want and confirm; only this scene is swapped back, the rest of the project stays as it is. The change is a single Undo step, so ↩ Undo reverses it. If a restored version references photos that are no longer in the project folder, CINEside shows a warning rather than leaving a broken reference. Available once the project has been saved at least once.

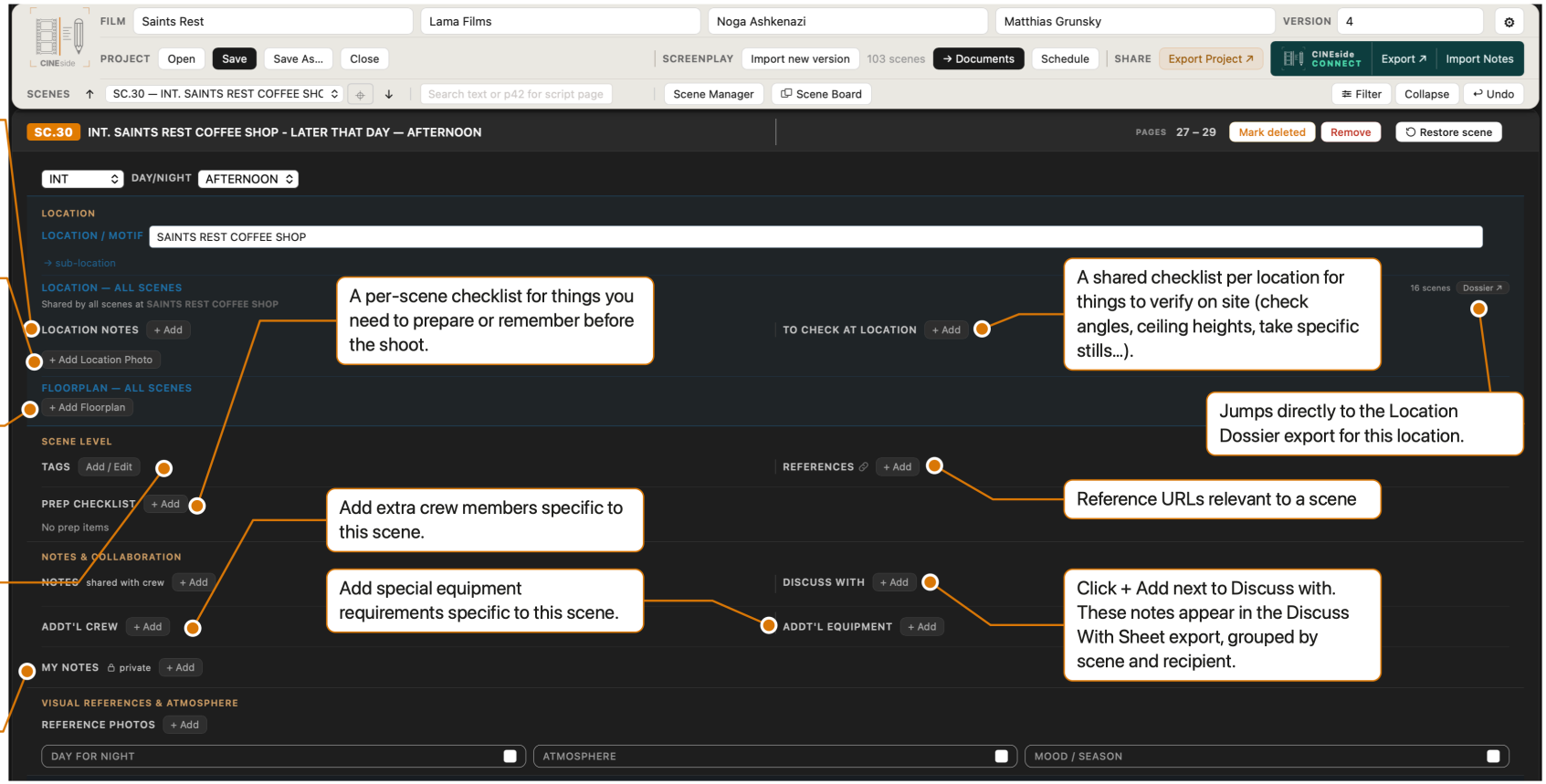
Free-text notes about the location- for example: "ND all windows", "remove all benches before shoot", "no parked cars in front of windows".

Reference images of the location. Shared across all scenes here. Add via the + button or drag from Finder. Each photo can have a caption.

Floor plan images for this location. Shared across all scenes here. Can also be shown in the Scene Board.

Click Add / Edit next to Tags. A modal lets you create a new tag with a custom color, assign an existing tag, or edit a tag you've already made.

Every scene has a private My Notes field. Excluded from all exports unless the My Notes toggle is explicitly enabled.



3.10 Scene Manager

Click Scene Manager in the toolbar to open a full-screen overview of all scenes. From here you can reposition, add, and remove scene boundaries, delete scenes entirely, and review anything left unresolved after a re-import.
The same view opens automatically right after a PDF import - both on first import and after re-importing a revised script - so you can review the detected or merged scene boundaries before continuing. Opening it manually via the toolbar works the same way, at any later point in your project.

Each scene card offers two distinct actions:
Merge into previous - dissolves the boundary between this scene and the one before it, folding its script text, shots, and notes into the previous scene. Useful when a scene was incorrectly split during PDF import.
Delete scene - removes the scene completely, including its script text, shots, and notes. This cannot be undone except via Undo (see below).

Undo - An Undo button is available directly in the Scene Manager header and footer, so you can step back from a merge, deletion, or boundary change without leaving this view.

Reviewing Script Changes:
If a re-import changed the text of one or more scenes, a N scenes changed by last import indicator appears at the top, with arrows to step through each affected scene - showing the actual added and removed text, not just the current version.

3.11 Part Divide

Back in the main scene view, split a long scene into parts without creating separate scenes. Select text in the script at the point where you want the split, then click ✂ Divide in the anchor popup. Divide splits the shot above the line currently shown in the anchor popup.
Parts appear as separate units in the Schedule and can be assigned to different shooting days independently.

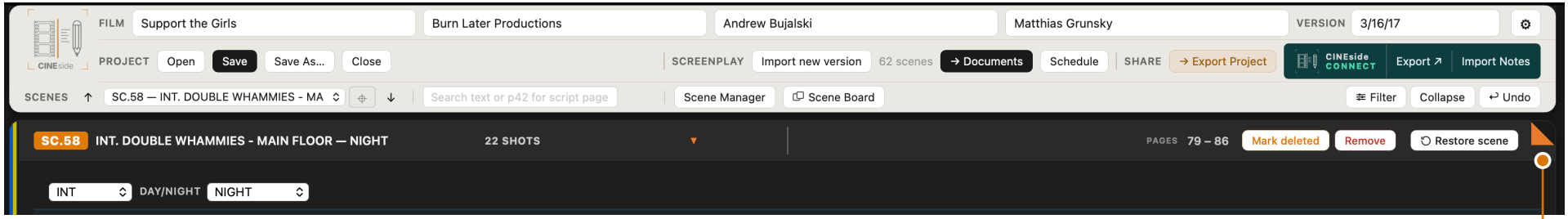
After a Re-Import:
If a script re-import changes the text right around a part boundary, the boundary is automatically re-anchored to the same passage where possible. If the surrounding text changed too much to relocate it reliably, the boundary shows a ⚠ boundary out of sync warning with a Re-anchor button in its place - select the correct line and click ✂ Divide again to fix it. Any such boundaries are also included in the N issues still out of sync notice described in 2.2, so you can jump straight to them.

3.12 Marking Scenes as Shot

Once a scene is in the can, click the top-right corner of its scene header. The corner folds over like a dog-eared page and stays visible while you scroll through the scene, because the scene header stays pinned at the top. Click the corner again to remove the mark.

The dog-ear is just a mark for you - it doesn't lock, hide, or change anything in the scene, and it never appears in PDF exports, CONNECT packages, or the For Director / For Cinematographer packages. It travels with the project in a Full export (see 10.1), so a scene marked on your Mac shows as marked on your iPad, and the other way around.

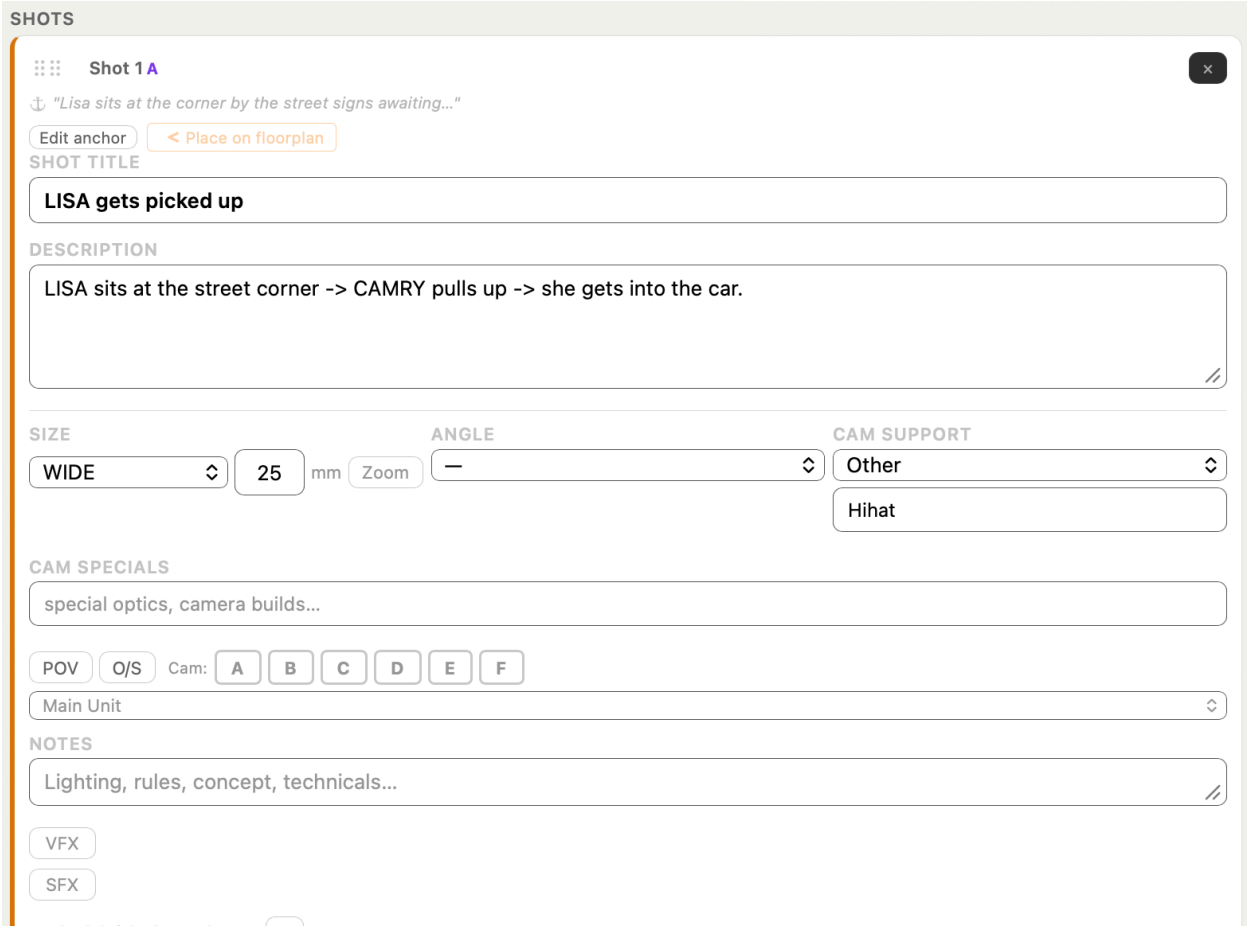
To see what's still left to shoot, use the Status filter (see 2.6).
On iPad: tap the corner. A faint corner is always visible as a hint. The dog-ear also works while Reading Lock is on, so you can check off scenes on set without unlocking.



4 Shots

4.1 Creating a Shot

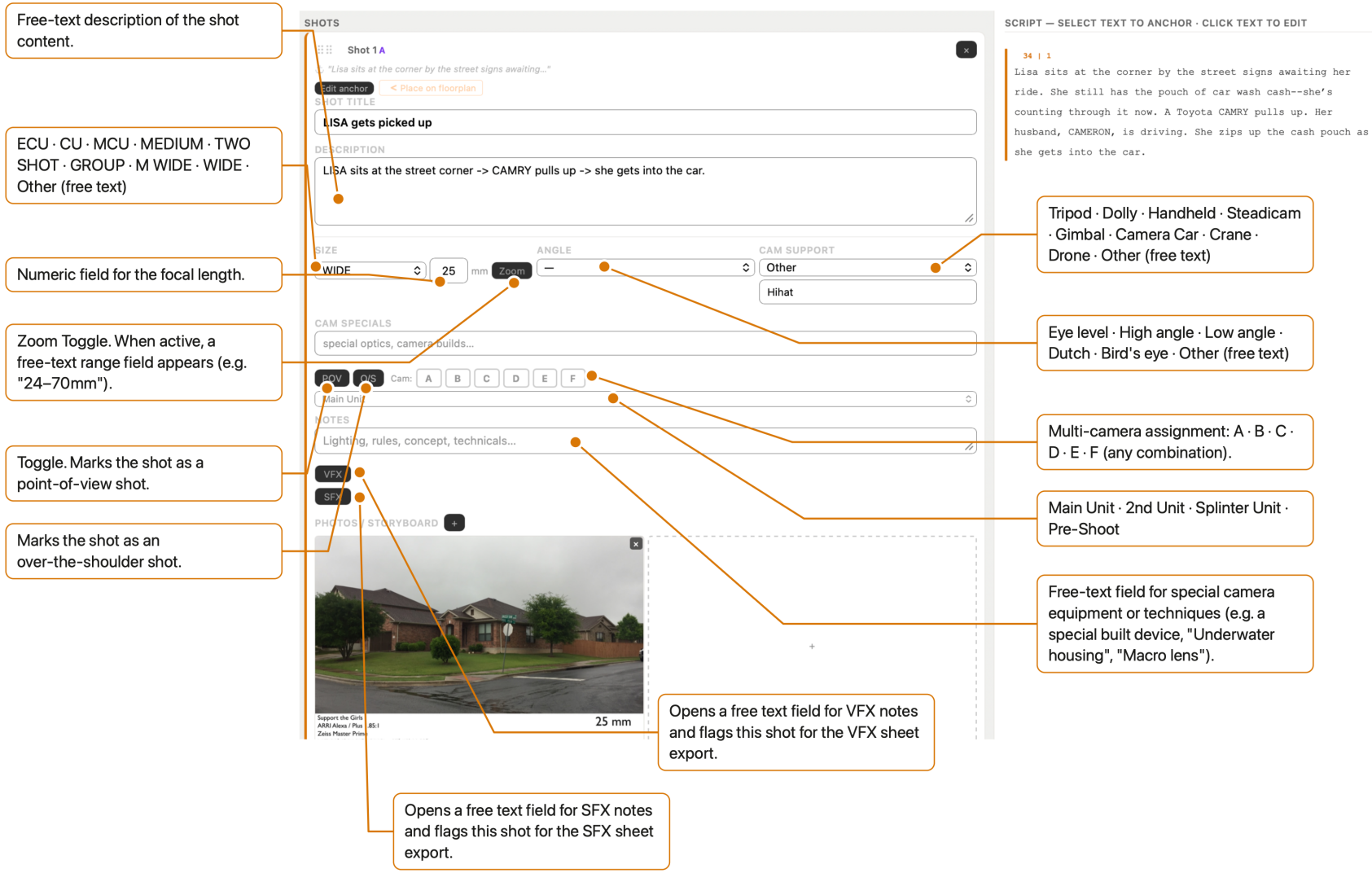
Click + Add shot in the shots column of any scene, or select text in the script and click + Shot in the anchor popup. The second method creates a shot already anchored to the selected passage.



4.2 Shot Fields

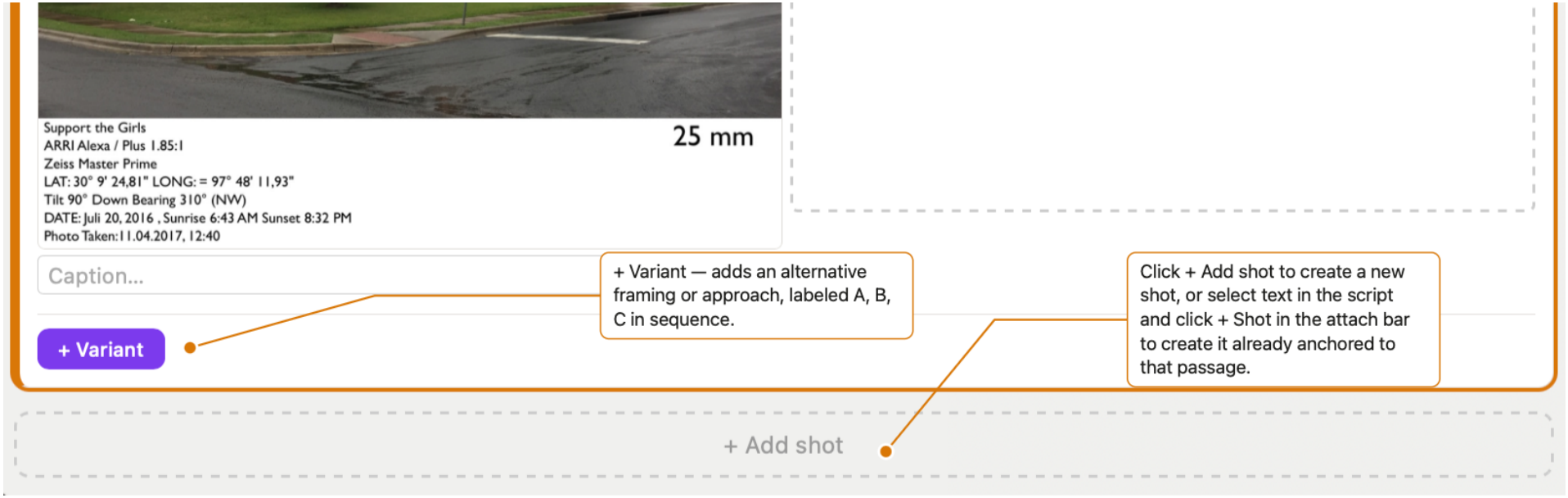
Each shot card begins with the shot header and its anchor controls (Set anchor / Place on floorplan), followed by Shot Title and Description. A thin divider separates these from the technical fields below - Size, Angle, Cam Support, Cam Specials, POV / O-S / Cam / Unit, Cam Moves, Notes, VFX / SFX - and finally the shot photos and any variants.

Shot Title	A short name for the shot. Appears in the shot navigation dropdown (4.7), the Schedule, and all exports.
Description	Free-text description of the shot content.
Size	ECU · CU · MCU · MEDIUM · TWO SHOT · GROUP · M WIDE · WIDE · Other (free text)
mm (focal length)	Numeric field for the focal length.
Zoom	Toggle. When active, a free-text range field appears (e.g. "24–70mm").
Angle	Eye level · High angle · Low angle · Dutch · Bird's eye · Other (free text)
Cam Support	Tripod · Dolly · Handheld · Steadicam · Gimbal · Camera Car · Crane · Drone · Other (free text)
POV	Toggle. Marks the shot as a point-of-view shot.
O/S	Toggle. Marks the shot as an over-the-shoulder shot.
Camera	Multi-camera assignment: A · B · C · D · E · F (any combination).
Unit	Main Unit · 2nd Unit · Splinter Unit · Pre-Shoot
Cam Specials	Free-text field for special camera equipment or techniques (e.g. a special built device, "Underwater housing", "Macro lens").
VFX	Toggle. Opens a free text field for VFX notes and flags this shot for the VFX sheet export.
SFX	Toggle. Opens a free text field for SFX notes and flags this shot for the SFX sheet export.
Notes	Free-text notes for this shot.
Cam Moves	Camera movement annotations anchored to a script passage and attached to this shot. Created via the anchor popup (see 6.2); always included in exports.
Photos	Reference images attached to this shot. Add via the + button. Drag and drop from Finder works from the second image onward.


Free-text description of the shot content.
ECU · CU · MCU · MEDIUM · TWO SHOT · GROUP · M WIDE · WIDE · Other (free text)
Numeric field for the focal length.
Zoom Toggle. When active, a free-text range field appears (e.g. "24–70mm").
Toggle. Marks the shot as a point-of-view shot.
Marks the shot as an over-the-shoulder shot.
SHOTS
Shot 1 A
Edit anchor
Place on floorplan
SHOT TITLE
LISA gets picked up
DESCRIPTION
LISA sits at the street corner -> CAMRY pulls up -> she gets into the car.
SIZE
WIDE
25
mm
Zoom
ANGLE
CAM SUPPORT
Other
Hihat
CAM SPECIALS
special optics, camera builds...
POV
OS
Cam:
A
B
C
D
E
F
Main Unit
NOTES
Lighting, rules, concept, technicals...
VFX
SFX
PHOTOS / STORYBOARD
25 mm
SCRIPT — SELECT TEXT TO ANCHOR · CLICK TEXT TO EDIT
34 | 1
Lisa sits at the corner by the street signs awaiting her ride. She still has the pouch of car wash cash--she's counting through it now. A Toyota CAMRY pulls up. Her husband, CAMERON, is driving. She zips up the cash pouch as she gets into the car.
Tripod · Dolly · Handheld · Steadicam · Gimbal · Camera Car · Crane · Drone · Other (free text)
Eye level · High angle · Low angle · Dutch · Bird's eye · Other (free text)
Multi-camera assignment: A · B · C · D · E · F (any combination).
Main Unit · 2nd Unit · Splinter Unit · Pre-Shoot
Free-text field for special camera equipment or techniques (e.g. a special built device, "Underwater housing", "Macro lens").
Opens a free text field for VFX notes and flags this shot for the VFX sheet export.
Opens a free text field for SFX notes and flags this shot for the SFX sheet export.

4.3 Shot Variants

A shot can have multiple variants - alternative framings, lenses, or approaches for the otherwise same shot. Click + Variant on any shot to add a variant labeled A, B, C in sequence.
Variants inherit the parent shot's anchor. Each variant has its own Size, mm, Angle, Cam Support, and Cam Specials fields, plus its own Description and Notes.



4.4 Shot Labels

In Preferences, choose whether shots within a scene are labeled numerically (1, 2, 3 ...) or alphabetically (A, B, C ...). This affects the editor, all exports, and the schedule.

4.5 Anchoring Shots to the Script

Select text in the script and the anchor popup appears. It belongs to the scene you selected in; the scene number is shown in its header. To anchor text in another scene, select text there.

The popup follows your selection. Select a different passage and it updates; it stays where it is unless it would cover the selected text.
The shot dropdown shows the active shot card, so in most cases you simply confirm. If that shot has lost its anchor, the button reads Re-anchor.

The popup offers three actions:

- Anchor — anchors the selection to the shot in the dropdown.
- Add to anchor — adds the selection to that shot's existing anchor.
- Not in frame: 3. Name — excludes the selection from the shot named on the button. This is the active shot card if its anchor contains the selection, otherwise the innermost anchor around it. The button is greyed out when no anchor contains the selection. Typical uses are a cutaway, an insert or a reaction covered by another shot. To cover the passage again, select it and choose Add to anchor.

While a Note, Lighting or Cam Move field is open, only that field, Save, Cancel and the close button are active (Cam Move also keeps its shot selector). Cancel closes the field; the ✕ in the top corner closes the whole popup.

If you have typed into a field and then select text in a different scene, the hint “Stays in SC.N” appears below the field: your text remains with the scene you started in. An empty Note or Lighting field stays open when you move to another scene; an empty Cam Move field closes.

Edit and Divide act on the line shown in the popup. Clicking into the script leaves the popup open.

Anchors and gaps are kept when you re-import a revised screenplay, as long as the surrounding lines can still be matched.

On iPad: the shot card additionally lists the passages the shot covers, each with an × to remove it - handy because a text selection is dropped as soon as you tap a button.
Selecting script text opens the anchor popup. To take text out of the script, use + Note or Edit in the popup rather than the iOS copy menu. While Reading Lock is on, the boxes in the number row are inactive.

4.6 Reading the script column

Each anchored shot is drawn as a coloured line beside the script text. Within a scene every shot has its own lane, so a shot that covers several passages runs in the same position from top to bottom. The label on the line is the shot number — “1”, “3B”, “1 MOVE”.
A number row at the top of the script column lists the shots of the current scene above their lanes. A small box marks the first line of each shot.
Passages marked Not in frame are drawn pale and dashed.

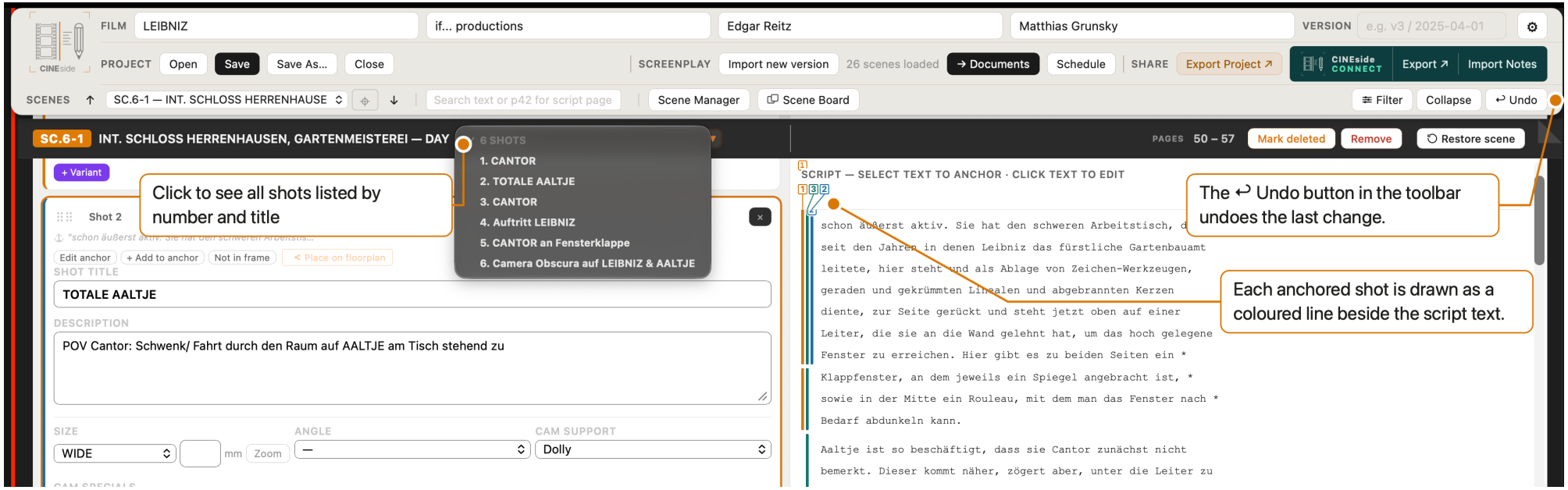
Click a box or a number in the row to open that shot card. Selecting a shot card scrolls the script to the first line of the shot.

4.7 Shot Navigation

The scene header shows the total number of shots for that scene as a dropdown - for example 8 SHOTS ▼. Click it to see all shots listed by number and title. Selecting a shot jumps directly to it. This is useful when a scene has many shots and you want to navigate without scrolling.

4.8 Undo

The ↩ Undo button in the toolbar undoes the last change. Up to 40 undo steps are available within a session. Undo covers your scenes and shots as well as location data - location notes, photos, floorplans, sub-locations, and To Check items. It does not cover the project fields at the top (Film, Production, Director, Cinematographer, Version) or the schedule. If you undo the removal of a photo, the image comes back automatically.



5 Visual References

Visual references can be attached at two levels: to individual shots, or to scenes. Scene-level references are shared across the scene and appear in the Scene Board.

5.1 Shot Photos

Attach reference images, viewfinder stills or storyboards directly to a shot. Add via the + button below the shot fields, or drag an image file from Finder onto the shot photo area. Drag and drop from Finder works from the second image onward.
Each photo can have a caption. Photos appear in the PDF export when the Shot Photos toggle is enabled.

> On iPad: tap + Add to open the system picker (Photos, Camera, or Files).

5.2 Scene-Level References

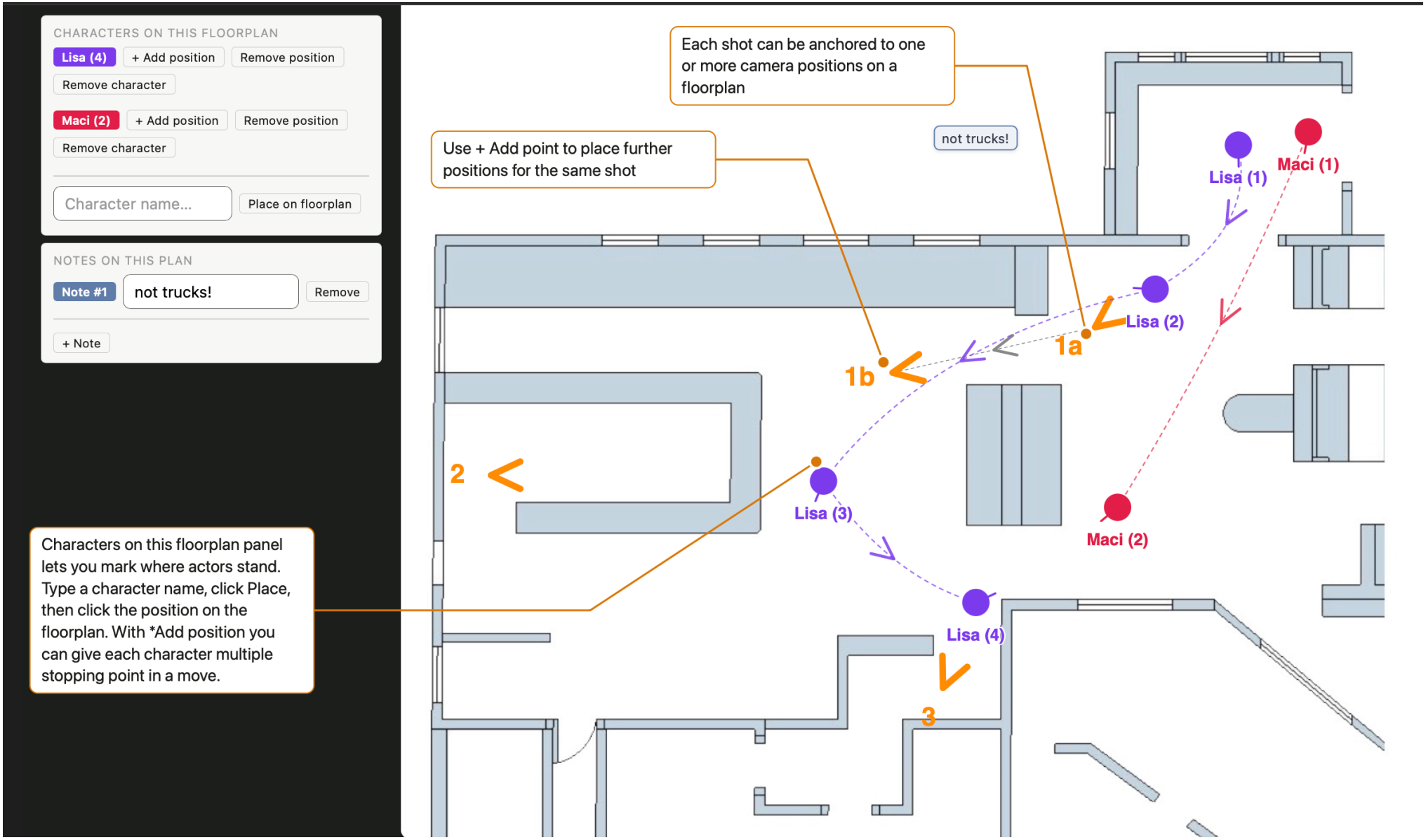
Reference Photos	Mood images, color references, location details. Each photo can have a caption.
Sun Position	Screenshots from Helios, PhotoPills, or similar apps. Included in Lighting exports (see 7.3, 8.4)
Lighting Plan	Lighting diagrams or sketches. Click any image to open the lightbox and rotate. Exported when the Lighting toggle is enabled.
Floorplan - Scene	Overheads, or hand-drawn visual notes, specific to this one scene. Click to open lightbox and rotate. Exported when the Floorplan - Scene toggle is enabled.

5.3 Anchors on Floorplans & Lighting Plans

Anchors let you mark exactly where things sit on a plan - camera and character positions, where a light is rigged, or where a grip element runs. Camera and character anchors are placed on Floorplans - Scene; light and grip anchors on Lighting Plan images. All anchors are drawn directly on the image, carry through to the relevant PDF exports, and appear live in the Scene Board. Camera and character anchors are also included in packages sent to CONNECT.

Camera Positions
Each shot can be anchored to one or more camera positions on a floorplan. In the shot, click Place on floorplan, then click the point on the floorplan where the camera sits - the chevron shows the viewing direction, which you can rotate. Use + Add point to place further positions for the same shot (for a move or a reset), and Remove to delete the last one.
If a scene has more than one floorplan, a camera position can sit on any of them - just click the floorplan you want. The shot then shows which floorplan its anchor is on (for example, “On floorplan 2”).

Character Positions
Left of each floorplan, the Characters on this floorplan panel lets you mark where actors stand. Type a character name, click Place, then click the position on the floorplan. Character positions are tied to the floorplan they are placed on, and the same character can appear on more than one floorplan within the scene.


CHARACTERS ON THIS FLOORPLAN
Lisa (4)
+ Add position
Remove position
Remove character
Maci (2)
+ Add position
Remove position
Remove character
Character name...
Place on floorplan
NOTES ON THIS PLAN
Note #1
not trucks!
Remove
+ Note
Each shot can be anchored to one or more camera positions on a floorplan
Use + Add point to place further positions for the same shot
Characters on this floorplan panel lets you mark where actors stand. Type a character name, click Place, then click the position on the floorplan. With *Add position you can give each character multiple stopping point in a move.
not trucks!
Lisa (1)
Maci (1)
Lisa (2)
1a
1b
2
Lisa (3)
Maci (2)
Lisa (4)
3

Lights

Left of each lighting plan, the Lights on this plan panel lets you create fixtures. Choose a type from the picker - each shows its own symbol - then click Place on plan and click the position on the lighting plan. Add a free-text label for the specific unit (e.g. “M18”, “Astera tube”, “practical lamp”). The six types are archetypes, not a device list; put the exact instrument in the label field.

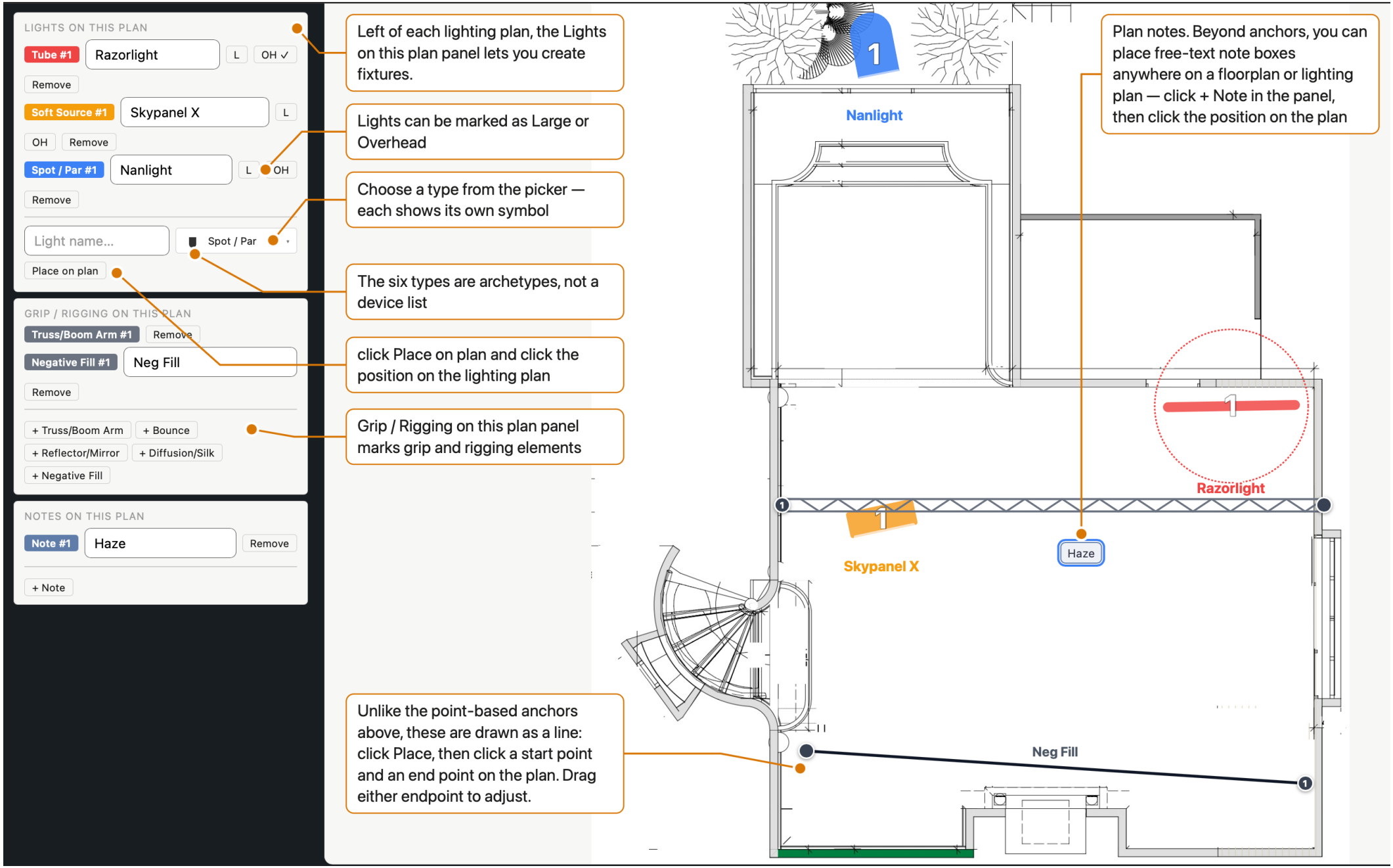
Spot / Par	Hard, focusable or par-style sources.
Fresnel	Fresnel-lensed tungsten or LED units.
Soft Source	Soft lights and softboxes.
Tube	Tube-style sources (e.g. LED tubes).
Spacelight / Lantern	Overhead ambient sources - spacelights and lanterns.
Practical	In-shot practical lamps and fixtures.

Lights can be marked as Large or Overhead; both change how the symbol is drawn on the plan.

Grip / Rigging

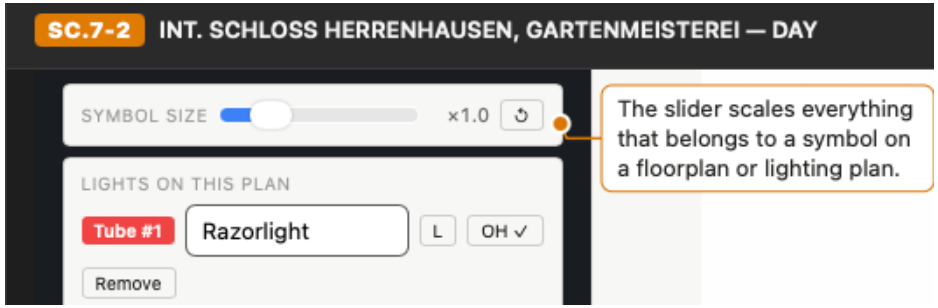
Left of each lighting plan, the Grip / Rigging on this plan panel marks grip and rigging elements. Unlike the point-based anchors above, these are drawn as a line: click Place, then click a start point and an end point on the plan. Drag either endpoint to adjust. Most types take a free-text label; Truss / Boom Arm is drawn without one.

Truss / Boom Arm	A rigged truss or boom arm run.
Bounce	Bounce boards and reflective surfaces.
Reflector / Mirror	harder reflectors and mirrors.
Diffusion / Silk	Diffusion frames and silks.
Negative Fill	Negative fill and floppies.


LIGHTS ON THIS PLAN
Tube #1
Razorlight
L
OH ✓
Remove
Soft Source #1
Skypanel X
L
OH
Remove
Spot / Par #1
Nanlight
L
OH
Remove
Light name...
Spot / Par
Place on plan
GRIP / RIGGING ON THIS PLAN
Truss/Boom Arm #1
Remove
Negative Fill #1
Neg Fill
Remove
+ Truss/Boom Arm
+ Bounce
+ Reflector/Mirror
+ Diffusion/Silk
+ Negative Fill
NOTES ON THIS PLAN
Note #1
Haze
Remove
+ Note
Left of each lighting plan, the Lights on this plan panel lets you create fixtures.
Lights can be marked as Large or Overhead
Choose a type from the picker — each shows its own symbol
The six types are archetypes, not a device list
click Place on plan and click the position on the lighting plan
Grip / Rigging on this plan panel marks grip and rigging elements
Unlike the point-based anchors above, these are drawn as a line: click Place, then click a start point and an end point on the plan. Drag either endpoint to adjust.
Plan notes. Beyond anchors, you can place free-text note boxes anywhere on a floorplan or lighting plan — click + Note in the panel, then click the position on the plan
Nanlight
Razorlight
Skypanel X
Haze
Neg Fill

Plan notes
Beyond anchors, you can place free-text note boxes anywhere on a floorplan or lighting plan - click + Note in the panel, then click the position on the plan. Drag a note to reposition it, click its text to edit. Notes are kept separately per plan and are included in all PDF exports.

Symbol size
CINEside does not know the scale of a plan - on a drawing of a football field a figure stands for metres, on a car sketch for centimetres. So each plan has its own symbol size. At the top of the legend of every floorplan and lighting plan, the Symbols panel shows a slider from ×0.5 to ×3.0 (default ×1.0); ↺ resets it. Dragging previews the change, releasing saves it as one undo step.
The factor scales everything that belongs to a symbol - camera and character glyphs, light symbols and their labels, note boxes, line thickness of grip and movement lines - but not the length of a line or the anchor position itself, so nothing moves. Handles never get smaller than at ×1.0. The factor is stored per plan with the project, applies to the PDF exports, the Scene Board and the floorplan images sent to CONNECT, and is read the same way on Mac and iPad. In the locked/reading mode the slider is disabled.



Rotating a plan with anchors
A floorplan or lighting plan can be rotated by clicking the image to open the lightbox. Once anchors are placed on a plan, rotation is locked - otherwise the anchor positions would no longer match the image. To rotate, remove the anchors first, rotate, then place them again.

In exports and the Scene Board
PDF: camera and character anchors appear on floorplans when the Floorplan - Scene toggle is on; light and grip anchors appear on lighting plans when the Lighting toggle is on. A legend lists the lights and grip elements on each plan.
CONNECT: camera and character anchors are baked into the floorplan images sent to directors. Light and grip anchors are not sent - they live on the lighting plans, which stay inside CINEside.
Scene Board: all anchors are drawn on the board and update automatically after every change, so a director on a second screen always sees the current plan.

5.4 Location-Level References

Location Photos and the Location Floorplan live in the blue Location panel below the scene header (see 3.3) rather than in the scene body itself. They're shared across every scene at that location - add or edit them once, and the change appears everywhere that location is used.
Both also appear in the Scene Board.

5.5 Promote a Photo to a Plan

Any reference photo - a scouting shot of a location, a hand-drawn floorplan from your notebook, a screenshot from Google Earth - can be turned into a working floorplan or lighting plan with one tap. This works from two places: the Reference Photos of a scene (5.2), and the Location Photos of a location (5.4).

Tap the photo to open it full-screen. In the toolbar above the image, use the buttons to promote it:

- From a scene's Reference Photo:

  Use as Floorplan adds it to that scene's Floorplans - Scene block,
  Use as Lighting Plan adds it to the Lighting Plan block. Both are independent - you can promote the same photo to both.

- From a Location's photo:

  Use as Floorplan adds it to the location's shared Floorplan block. Lighting plans stay per-scene, so this option is not offered at the location level.

The original stays where it was - promotion adds a copy of the photo to the target block, both referring to the same image file. Once the copy is in a plan block, it behaves like any other plan: you can place anchors on it (5.3), and it appears in exports and the Scene Board.

The buttons toggle. If a photo has already been promoted, the button changes to Remove from Floorplans or Remove from Lighting Plans - tap it to take the copy back out. If anchors have been placed on the promoted copy, CINEside asks for confirmation before removing it, so anchor work is never lost by accident. Deleting the original from Reference Photos or Location Photos leaves any promoted copies and their anchors untouched.

5.6 Scene Board

The Scene Board is optional - open it via Scene Board in the toolbar when you want a dedicated view of a scene's visual references, across all three levels. The board updates automatically as you navigate between scenes. Anchors are drawn on the board too and refresh live after every change. Move it to a second monitor or use it on an iPad via macOS Sidecar.

Floorplan - Location tab	Location floorplans for this scene's location.
Location tab	Location photos for this scene's location.
Lighting tab	Lighting plan images for this scene.
Floorplan - Scene tab	Floorplans for this scene.
Reference tab	Reference photos for this scene.
Scene Info tab	Alongside the visual tabs, a **Scene Info** tab lists the scene's filled-in text details as a clean overview - Location, Additional Crew, Additional Equipment, open Prep Checklist items, Day for Night / Atmosphere / Mood, and Lighting Notes. Like every tab, it appears only when there is something to show.

Only tabs with content are shown; click between them to switch which category you're viewing.
When a tab has multiple images, a thumbnail strip appears at the bottom - click a thumbnail to display it full-size.

The Scene Board opens in landscape orientation and can be freely resized. It opens on demand - its state is not saved between sessions.

> On iPad: the Scene Board is not available - it requires a second monitor. This is a Mac-only feature.

5.7 Sketch Pad (iPad only)

On iPad: You can draw a sketch anywhere it makes sense: as a storyboard frame in a shot, as a scene reference, as a location photo - or directly as a floorplan or lighting plan. (Sun position uses photos only.) Sketches become photos in your project: they carry captions, appear in PDF exports, are included in CONNECT packages, and can be reordered, deleted, or promoted like any other photo.

Next to every + add photo button - in shots (5.1), in scene reference photos (5.2), in scene floorplan and lighting plan blocks (5.3), in location photos and location floorplans (5.4) - you'll find a + Draw button. Tap it to open Sketch Pad, sketch with your Apple Pencil, and tap Save. The drawing lands in that block as a photo.

Sketch Pad works with Apple Pencil for clean, precise strokes - rest your palm on the screen while you draw.

Tools:

Pen and Eraser at the top left. Undo and Redo work on strokes locally within Sketch Pad; the finished sketch enters the project undo stack as a single "photo added".

Aspect ratios:

Sketches for shots offer nine ratios: 1:1, 1.33, 1.37, 1.66, 1.78, 1.85, 2:1, 2.39, and 2.75:1 - chosen from the picker at the top. Your last choice is remembered per project, so all following shot sketches in that project open in the same format by default. You can still change it for any individual sketch before you start drawing. Once you've drawn the first stroke, the ratio is locked for that sketch.

Sketches for reference photos, floorplans, lighting plans, and location photos always use 4:3 - no picker is shown. Shot sketches are frames (aspect ratio matters); the others are notes (the aspect ratio doesn't).

Saving:

Save the project before drawing your first sketch. Sketch Pad writes to the project folder like any other photo, and needs the folder to exist. If the project hasn't been saved yet, Sketch Pad prompts you to save first.

After saving, a sketch is a photo - flat, not stroke-editable. If you want to change it, draw a new one and delete the old one. This is a deliberate choice: it keeps sketches consistent with the rest of your reference photos, and means anchors placed on a sketched floorplan behave exactly like anchors on any other floorplan image.

6 Notes & Annotations

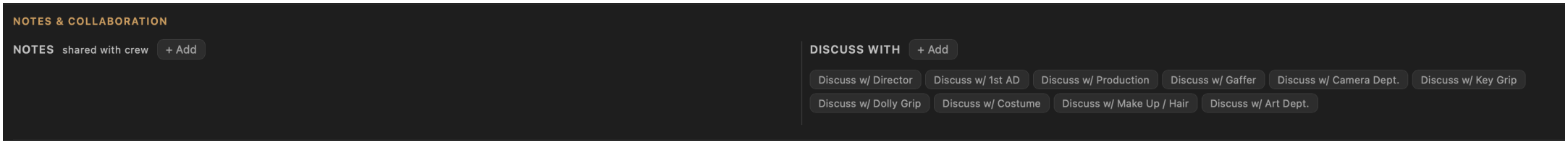
6.1 Discuss With

Click + Add next to Discuss with. A row of recipient buttons appears - click the department you want to address. A note field opens immediately with the correct recipient already set. Each note has a row of small color swatches - click one to set that note's color.

Cinematographer mode
- Discuss w/ Director
- Discuss w/ 1st AD
- Discuss w/ Production
- Discuss w/ Gaffer
- Discuss w/ Camera Dept.
- Discuss w/ Key Grip
- Discuss w/ Dolly Grip
- Discuss w/ Costume
- Discuss w/ Make Up / Hair
- Discuss w/ Art Dept.

Director mode
- Discuss w/ Cinematographer
- Discuss w/ 1st AD
- Discuss w/ Production
- Discuss w/ Screenwriter
- Discuss w/ Casting
- Discuss w/ Actor (with optional actor name field)
- Discuss w/ Editor
- Discuss w/ Composer
- Discuss w/ Costume
- Discuss w/ Make Up / Hair
- Discuss w/ Art Dept.

These notes appear in the Discuss With Sheet export, grouped by scene and recipient.



6.2 Script Annotations

Select text in the script and click one of the Annotation buttons in the anchor popup:

+ Note	A general note linked to the selected passage. Grey stripe in the script. Exported when the Script Notes toggle is enabled.
💡 **Lighting**	A lighting note linked to the selected passage. Amber stripe. Exported when the Lighting toggle is enabled.
🎥 **Cam Move**	A camera movement note linked to the selected passage. Red stripe. Always included in exports.

Annotations appear at the bottom of the script column in the editor for reference, and inline in the script in the PDF export. Click the text of any annotation to edit it; click ✕ to remove it.

6.3 My Notes

Every scene has a private My Notes field. It never appears in PDF exports unless the My Notes toggle is explicitly enabled, and it is never included in CONNECT packages (.cnct) or in share packages (.cnsf) - except the Full export (10.1), which is a deliberate 1:1 copy.

6.4 CONNECT Notes

When you import a .cnsn file from a collaborator, their annotations appear highlighted in your project - on shots, script passages, and images. A green floating Next Note button (bottom right) lets you navigate through all unreviewed notes using the keyboard shortcut N (next) and P (previous).
Mark notes as done individually using the ✓ button, copy them to a scene note using → Note, or delete them using ✕. The "All notes reviewed" confirmation appears once you have worked through all pending notes in a session.
CONNECT notes attached to script lines are kept when you import a revised screenplay (see 2.2).

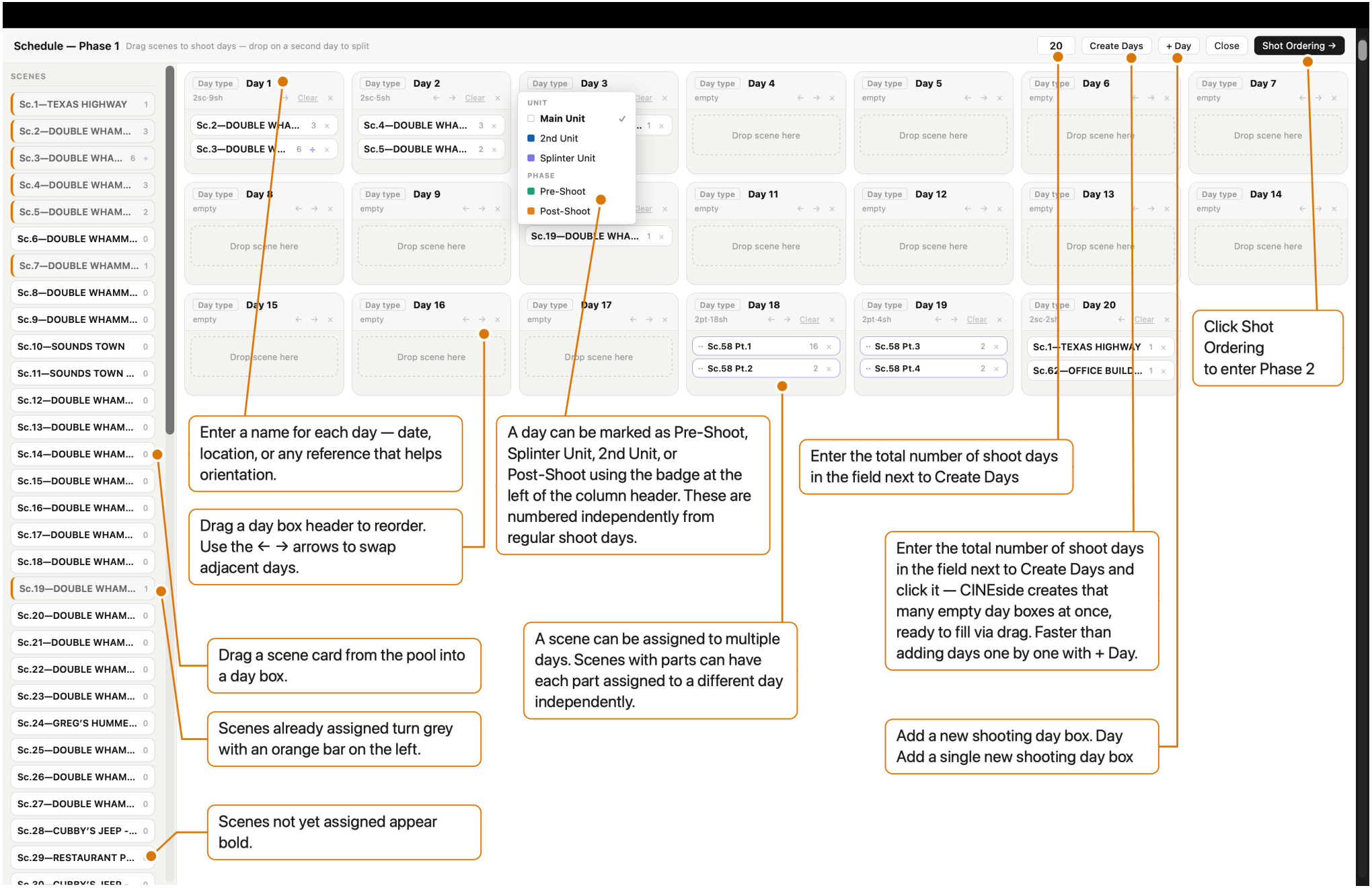
CONNECT Notes are not included in any export unless you copy them to a scene note using the → Note button.

7 Schedule

The Schedule in CINEside is a tool to work out the shooting order for each day - in conversation with your AD and director. It is not meant as a replacement for dedicated production scheduling software such as Movie Magic, Yamdu, or Fuzzlecheck.
Click Schedule in the toolbar to open the Schedule. The workflow has two phases.

7.1 Phase 1 - Assigning Scenes to Days

Create Days	Enter the total number of shoot days in the field next to Create Days and click it - CINEside creates that many empty day boxes at once, ready to fill via drag. Faster than adding days one by one with + Day.
+ Day	Day Add a single new shooting day box - useful for adding one more day after the initial setup, or when you don't yet know the total number of days.
Day label	Enter a name for each day - date, location, or any reference that helps orientation.
Assign via drag	Drag a scene card from the pool into a day box.
Pool behavior	Scenes not yet assigned appear bold. Scenes already assigned turn grey with an orange bar on the left.
Split scenes	A scene can be assigned to multiple days. Scenes with parts can have each part assigned to a different day independently.
Reorder days	Drag a day box header to reorder. Use the ← → arrows to swap adjacent days.
Day types	A day can be marked as Pre-Shoot, Splinter Unit, 2nd Unit, or Post-Shoot using the badge at the left of the column header. These are numbered independently from regular shoot days.


Schedule — Phase 1
Drag scenes to shoot days — drop on a second day to split
20
Create Days
+ Day
Close
Shot Ordering →
SCENES
Day 1
Day 2
Day 3
Day 4
Day 5
Day 6
Day 7
Day 8
Day 9
Day 11
Day 12
Day 13
Day 14
Day 15
Day 16
Day 17
Day 18
Day 19
Day 20
UNIT
Main Unit
2nd Unit
Splinter Unit
PHASE
Pre-Shoot
Post-Shoot
Drop scene here
Click Shot Ordering to enter Phase 2
Enter a name for each day — date, location, or any reference that helps orientation.
A day can be marked as Pre-Shoot, Splinter Unit, 2nd Unit, or Post-Shoot using the badge at the left of the column header. These are numbered independently from regular shoot days.
Enter the total number of shoot days in the field next to Create Days
Drag a day box header to reorder. Use the ← → arrows to swap adjacent days.
Enter the total number of shoot days in the field next to Create Days and click it — CINEside creates that many empty day boxes at once, ready to fill via drag. Faster than adding days one by one with + Day.
A scene can be assigned to multiple days. Scenes with parts can have each part assigned to a different day independently.
Drag a scene card from the pool into a day box.
Add a new shooting day box. Day
Add a single new shooting day box
Scenes already assigned turn grey with an orange bar on the left.
Scenes not yet assigned appear bold.

7.2 Phase 2 - Ordering Shots

Click Shot Ordering → to enter Phase 2. Each shooting day has its own tab. Arrange shots into your planned production sequence.

Drag to reorder	Drag shots within a day to set the order.
Move between days	Drag a shot to a different day tab, or use the day selector on the shot card.
Estimated time	Enter an estimated time in minutes per shot. The running total for that day updates live in the tab header.
Adding blocks between shots	Beyond shots, you can drop non-shot blocks into the day: Prep, Break, Company Move, and Wrap-out. Use the Add block buttons above the shot list - each block is added to the top of the current day, then drag it into position between your shots. Every block takes free text and a duration in minutes, which counts toward the day's total. The shot counter for each day counts shots only, not blocks. Blocks appear as coloured bars in the Schedule PDF and as their own rows in the CSV export.

7.3 Schedule Export

PDF - This Day	Exports the shooting order for the currently selected day. Header shows label, shot count, and estimated total time.
PDF - All Days	Exports all shooting days as a single PDF. Each day starts on a new page with its header.
CSV	All days as a spreadsheet - one row per shot. For import into Excel, Numbers, or scheduling software.

Choose All Days (selected by default) or This Day, then click Export PDF ↗. Each day opens with a header showing the shot count and estimated total time. CSV ↗ exports all days as a spreadsheet for the AD.
Use the export toggles to control which elements are included: Scene Photos, Floorplan - This Scene, Location, Lighting, Flags, Crew & Equipment, Shot Photos, Notes, Anchor, Tags, and Links. Sun Position screenshots are also included when the Lighting toggle is enabled.

The schedule is saved with the project and restored when you reopen the Schedule modal.

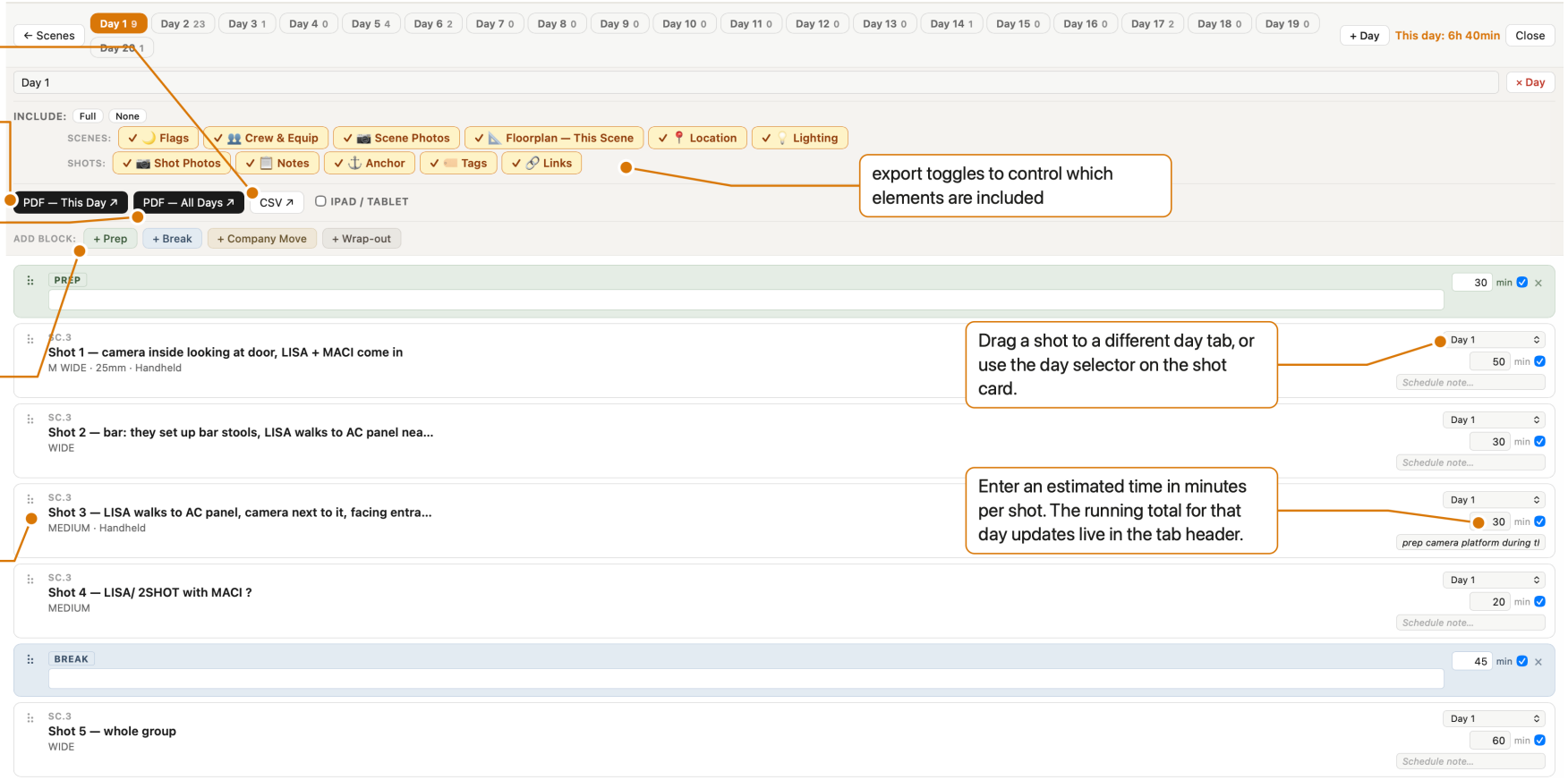
All days as a CSY spreadsheet — one row per shot.

Exports the shooting order for the currently selected day.

Exports all shooting days as a single PDF.

Beyond shots, you can drop non-shot blocks into the day: Prep, Break, Company Move, and Wrap-out.

Drag shots within a day to set the order.



export toggles to control which elements are included

Drag a shot to a different day tab, or use the day selector on the shot card.

Enter an estimated time in minutes per shot. The running total for that day updates live in the tab header.

8 Export

Click Documents ↗ in the toolbar to open the export window. It has six tabs. Every export works the same way: tabs and tiles only select - nothing starts until you click Export PDF ↗ at the bottom. Nothing is preselected, so a tap can never start an export by accident.

If an export can't be completed - the destination isn't writable, a referenced photo is missing, the disk is full - a window shows the actual error message. Fix the cause and export again; a failed export never changes your project. If you have unsaved changes, CINEside asks you to save before the destination dialog opens, so the file always matches what you see. This applies to every export, including CSV.

8.1 Shots & Script (Facing Pages)

A PDF with shots on the left and the screenplay on the right - one scene per spread. Anchored shots are drawn as lines in the left margin of the script page, running from the first to the last line each shot covers, with the shot number at the top - a lined script, as script supervisors keep it. Where a shot is marked Not in frame for part of its passage (4.5), the line is interrupted and drawn as a zigzag. With Print-friendly (B/W), every shot gets its own line style - solid, dashed, dotted - so shots stay distinguishable without color; the shot card on the facing page carries the same line, so card and script line can be matched at a glance. The shot number is repeated along long lines, so it is readable on every part of the page. Lighting notes on the same or adjacent lines share one "L" box in the margin.

Scenes without shots get a header page marked "0 Shots", so the PDF follows the scene order of the script.

The page keeps a margin on both sides for hole punching. Script annotations appear inline in the script. Use the Include toggles to control which elements - scene photos, shot photos, floorplan, location, lighting, and more - are added to the export.

8.2 Shot List Only

A PDF containing only the shot list, without script pages. Uses the same Include toggles as Shots & Script. This tab also offers the shot list as a CSV export - one row per shot, for spreadsheet work.

8.3 Scene List

A one-line-per-scene overview of the whole script - scene number, INT/EXT, slug line, and time of day - as either a landscape PDF or a CSV spreadsheet. Useful as a quick production reference, a stripping starting point, or a hand-off to other scheduling tools.

Two filters narrow which scenes are included:
INT / EXT - limit the list to interior or exterior scenes. INT-EXT scenes match both filters, so a scene marked INT/EXT appears whether you filter for interiors or exteriors.
Time of Day - limit the list by DAY, NIGHT, DAWN, DUSK, MORNING, or EVENING.
A live counter shows how many scenes match the current filter as you adjust it. The Scenes selection (8.10) still applies on top of the filters - so you can, for example, export only the exterior night scenes among a chosen subset. Choose PDF for a printable landscape sheet (oriented that way to fit long slug lines), or CSV for a spreadsheet you can open in Numbers or Excel.

8.4 Location Dossier

A PDF for one or more shooting locations. The location list, the Include toggles, an optional cover note, and the iPad / Tablet option are shown directly in the Location Dossier tab; select locations, then click Export PDF ↗.
The Dossier ↗button in a scene's location panel opens this tab with that location already selected. Select which locations to include and which elements to show via toggles. Sun Position screenshots are also included when the Lighting toggle is enabled.
Sub-locations are listed indented under their location and can be selected on their own - for example only "Boathouse → Pier" with all its scenes. Selecting a location includes all of its sub-locations; deselect individual ones to narrow the export. Where a location has both sub-locations and scenes without one, a "no sub-location" row lets you include or leave out those scenes. Locations that differ only in capitalisation count as one, and their notes, photos, floorplans and To Check items are combined in the PDF.

8.5 Reference Sheets

Choose one of the sheets - Notes Sheet, VFX Sheet, SFX Sheet, Addt'l Equipment, Addt'l Crew, or Discuss with - then click Export PDF ↗. For Addt'l Equipment, choose the categories (Camera, Cam Support / Dolly, Lighting, Grip) first. For Discuss with, the list of departments appears directly in the panel; use All / None or tick individual departments.

Notes Sheet	All scene notes sorted by scene.
VFX Sheet	All shots flagged as VFX, with their description and scene information.
SFX Sheet	All shots flagged as SFX, with their description and scene information.
Addt'l Equipment	All additional equipment entries across all scenes. Filter by category to send category-specific lists to departments.
Addt'l Crew	All additional crew entries across all scenes.
Discuss with...	All Discuss with notes, filter by recipients.

8.6 Prep Checklist

Exports all open prep checklist items across the project, grouped by scene. Checked-off items are excluded - this export always reflects only what's still outstanding.

8.7 iPad / Tablet Format

iPad / Tablet is a format option in the export dialog, not a separate tab. It uses the same layout with larger text for easier reading on a tablet. After each shot, a labeled "NOTES" box with a fine dot grid is added - space to write directly on the PDF with an Apple Pencil, without needing a wider margin elsewhere on the page. On the script pages, iPad / Tablet only enlarges the type; the lines, margins and page layout stay the same.

8.8 Include Toggles

Under Include, select which elements are added to the main PDF export.

Scene Photos	Reference photos attached at scene level.
Shot Photos	Reference images attached to individual shots.
Floorplan - This Scene	Scene-level floorplan and blocking diagrams.
Location	Location notes, location photos, and location floorplan per scene.
Lighting	Lighting plan images, lighting annotations from the script, and Sun Position screenshots.
Script Notes	Script annotations of type "Note" (grey), shown inline in the script.
My Notes	Private scene notes (excluded by default for sharing).
Tags	Scene tag stripes and labels.
Links	Reference links attached to scenes.

8.9 Filter

A quick **INT/EXT** and **Day/Night** filter narrows which scenes are included in the export. Because it sets the underlying scene selection, it applies to every export that uses it - Shots & Script, Shot List, Reference Sheets, Prep Checklist, and Location Dossier. After filtering you can still tick or untick individual scenes below. Each export dialog opens unfiltered; choosing Scenes → All also resets the filter.
(The Scene List export in 8.3 has its own separate INT/EXT and Time-of-Day filter and is not affected by this one.)

8.10 Scene Selection

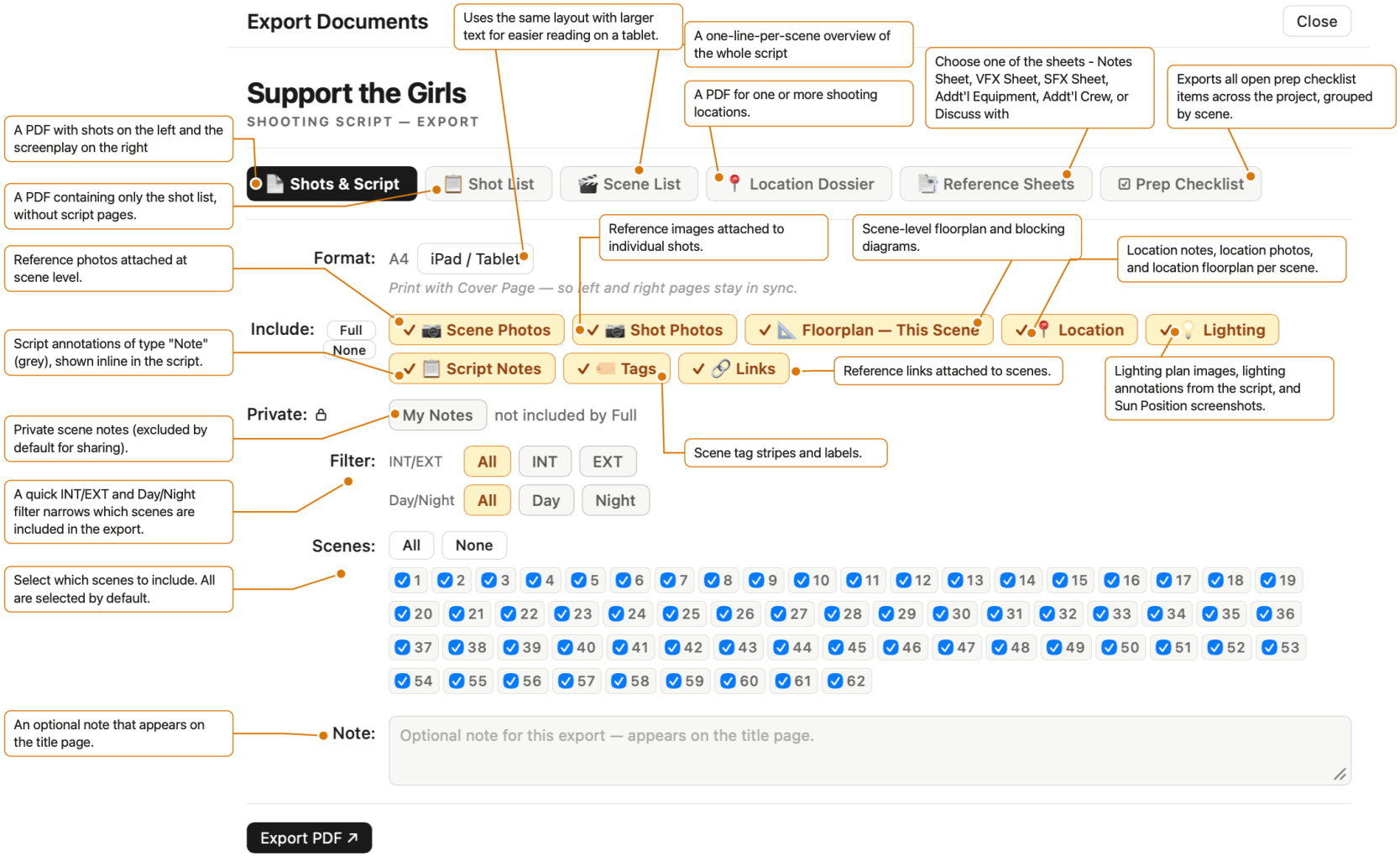
Under Scenes, select which scenes to include. All are selected by default. Use the All / None buttons to select or clear every scene at once, then deselect or reselect individual scenes for a partial export.

8.11 Export Note

An optional note that appears on the title page. Useful for version information or a message to collaborators.

8.12 Save & Share

When you export a PDF, CINEside hands it off to the system: save it wherever you like, then share it via Mail, AirDrop, Messages, or any other option macOS / iOS offers.



9 CINEside CONNECT

CINEside CONNECT is a free companion app for directors, cinematographers, and collaborators. It opens .cnct files in read-only mode - the recipient can annotate but not edit the project.
CONNECT is free on the App Store for Mac and iPad: https://apps.apple.com/app/cineside-connect/id6793694166
– your collaborators need nothing else.

9.1 Exporting to CONNECT

Click CONNECT → Export ↗ in the toolbar. CINEside creates a single .cnct file containing the shot list, script, and all reference images, and hands it to the system - save it and share it as you would any file (see 8.12).



The .cnct file is self-contained - all images are embedded. The recipient does not need access to your project folder.

9.2 Collaborator's Workflow (in CINEside CONNECT)

The recipient opens the .cnct file in CINEside CONNECT and can add notes to shots, script passages, and reference images. When finished, they export a .cnsn file and send it back. CINEside CONNECT can also export a PDF of the shooting script for printing or distribution.

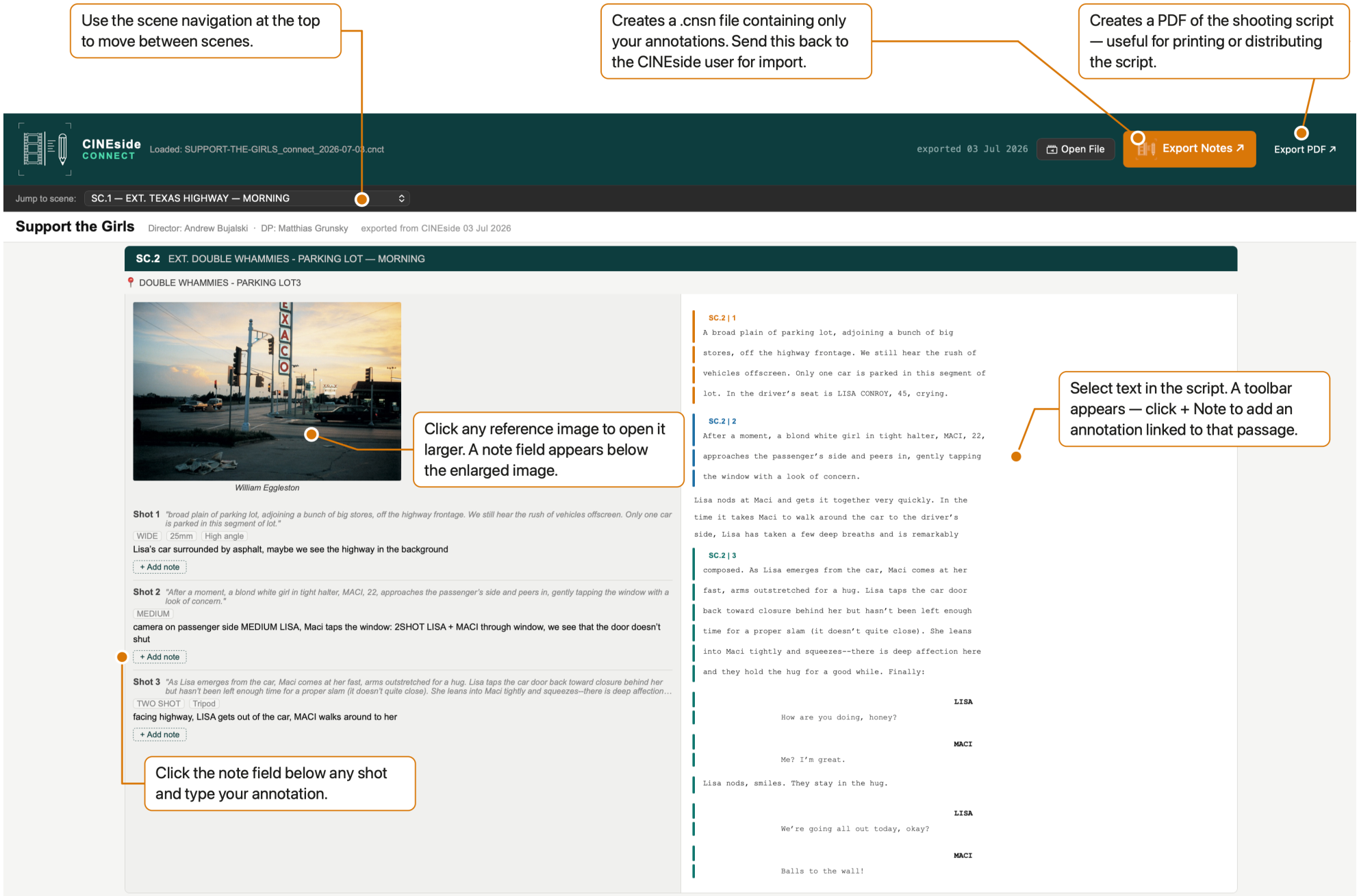


9.3 Importing Notes

Double-click the .cnsn file, or use CONNECT → Import Notes in the toolbar. Their annotations appear highlighted in your project. Use the Next Note button (shortcut N) to step through all unreviewed notes. Mark notes as done, copy them to a scene note using → Note, or delete them using ✕.

9.4 CONNECT works in both directions

The director can send you a .cnct file to annotate, and you return it as a .cnsn. Or you send the director a .cnct and they annotate it. CONNECT is role-neutral - any collaborator can use it regardless of their role in the project.


Use the scene navigation at the top to move between scenes.
Creates a .cnsn file containing only your annotations. Send this back to the CINEside user for import.
Creates a PDF of the shooting script — useful for printing or distributing the script.
CINEside
CONNECT
Loaded: SUPPORT-THE-GIRLS_connect_2026-07-03.cnct
exported 03 Jul 2026
Open File
Export Notes ↗
Export PDF ↗
Jump to scene:
SC.1 — EXT. TEXAS HIGHWAY — MORNING
Support the Girls
Director: Andrew Bujalski · DP: Matthias Grunsky
exported from CINEside 03 Jul 2026
SC.2 EXT. DOUBLE WHAMMIES - PARKING LOT — MORNING
DOUBLE WHAMMIES - PARKING LOT3
EXACO
William Eggleston
Click any reference image to open it larger. A note field appears below the enlarged image.
Shot 1 "broad plain of parking lot, adjoining a bunch of big stores, off the highway frontage. We still hear the rush of vehicles offscreen. Only one car is parked in this segment of lot."
WIDE
25mm
High angle
Lisa's car surrounded by asphalt, maybe we see the highway in the background
+ Add note
Shot 2 "After a moment, a blond white girl in tight halter, MACI, 22, approaches the passenger's side and peers in, gently tapping the window with a look of concern."
MEDIUM
camera on passenger side MEDIUM LISA, Maci taps the window: 2SHOT LISA + MACI through window, we see that the door doesn't shut
+ Add note
Shot 3 "As Lisa emerges from the car, Maci comes at her fast, arms outstretched for a hug. Lisa taps the car door back toward closure behind her but hasn't been left enough time for a proper slam (it doesn't quite close). She leans into Maci tightly and squeezes--there is deep affection…
TWO SHOT
Tripod
facing highway, LISA gets out of the car, MACI walks around to her
+ Add note
Click the note field below any shot and type your annotation.
SC.2 | 1
A broad plain of parking lot, adjoining a bunch of big stores, off the highway frontage. We still hear the rush of vehicles offscreen. Only one car is parked in this segment of lot. In the driver's seat is LISA CONROY, 45, crying.
SC.2 | 2
After a moment, a blond white girl in tight halter, MACI, 22, approaches the passenger's side and peers in, gently tapping the window with a look of concern.
Lisa nods at Maci and gets it together very quickly. In the time it takes Maci to walk around the car to the driver's side, Lisa has taken a few deep breaths and is remarkably
SC.2 | 3
composed. As Lisa emerges from the car, Maci comes at her fast, arms outstretched for a hug. Lisa taps the car door back toward closure behind her but hasn't been left enough time for a proper slam (it doesn't quite close). She leans into Maci tightly and squeezes--there is deep affection here and they hold the hug for a good while. Finally:
LISA
How are you doing, honey?
MACI
Me? I'm great.
Lisa nods, smiles. They stay in the hug.
LISA
We're going all out today, okay?
MACI
Balls to the wall!
Select text in the script. A toolbar appears — click + Note to add an annotation linked to that passage.

10 Sharing a Project

The → **Export Project** button creates a .cnsf package - a fully editable project the recipient opens in CINEside. Unlike CONNECT, the recipient can add shots, edit scenes, and continue working on the project. The button opens a dialog with three options:



10.1 Full → send to iPad/ Mac

A complete 1:1 copy with all notes and photos - including locations, sub-location photos, the full schedule, and dog-ears. Nothing removed. Use this to send the project to an iPad or Mac, or to move it between your own devices.

10.2 For Director

A package filtered for the director, stripped of your DP notes: lighting plans, sun position, additional crew and equipment entries, My Notes, and Discuss With notes addressed to Gaffer, Camera Dept., Key Grip, and Dolly Grip. All shots and visual references are included. Locations and the full schedule are included; dog-ears are not.

10.3 For Cinematographer

A package stripped of your director-private notes (screenwriter, casting, actor, editor, composer discussions, My Notes). All shots and visual references are included. Locations and the full schedule are included; dog-ears are not.

10.4 Receiving a Share Package

Double-click the .cnsf file. A dialog asks for a project name and save location. After confirmation it becomes a normal CINEside project on the recipient's machine - all reference photos are included and work immediately.
Packages created with very old CINEside versions (0.2.14 or earlier) can't be imported; CINEside tells you so before anything is written, so an existing project is never overwritten. If you import a package under the name of an existing project and choose Replace, the previous version is kept as a "Before replace" backup.

Although technically possible, it is not recommended for two people to both work in CINEside individually and send .cnsf packages back and forth - this would quickly become chaotic, as each export is a full project snapshot with no merge capability. The app works best if one person is the author of the file and the other collaborates via CONNECT.

11 Preferences

Click ⚙ in the top right of the toolbar to open Preferences.

Working Mode	Switch between Cinematographer and Director mode. Your data is never deleted when switching.
Shot Labels	Choose whether shots are labeled numerically (1, 2, 3) or alphabetically (A, B, C). Affects the editor, all exports, and the Schedule.
Page Format	Choose A4 or US Letter for all PDF exports. This is set once and applies across every project; change it only when you switch between working in Europe (A4) and the US (US Letter).
Default Projects Folder	Change where CINEside saves new projects. Default is ~/Movies/CINEside Projects. | Not available on iPad, where projects are always saved to the fixed CINEside Projects folder.

11.1 Automatic Updates

How CINEside updates depends on where you got it:

- App Store versions (Mac and iPad): updates are delivered through the App Store and install automatically if automatic updates are enabled on your device. There is no in-app update check - the App Store handles everything.
- Direct-download version (Mac): CINEside checks for new versions in the background when you launch. If an update is available, a dialog asks whether to install it. You can also check for updates manually via the CINEside menu → Check for Updates at any time. Only updates signed by the official CINEside signing key are accepted.

Switching from the direct download to the App Store version: if you bought CINEside before the App Store release, you can move to the App Store version at any time - download it from the Mac App Store for free and sign in with your purchase e-mail and license key (see 1.2). Your projects are ordinary files on your Mac and stay untouched; open them once via Open in the new version to rebuild the recent-projects list. Both versions can run side by side, but each signed-in installation counts toward your device limit - once you've settled into the App Store version, use Preferences → License → Deactivate This Device in the direct-download version to free up the slot. From then on, updates simply arrive through the App Store.

11.2 Automatic Backups

Saving is atomic - a crash or power loss mid-save can never leave a half-written project file. After you have saved your project for the first time, CINEside creates a backup every time it saves - when you save manually (Cmd+S), and when the automatic background save runs (every 5 minutes, only if something has changed). The three most recent backups are kept in the .backups/ folder inside your project folder.

In addition to these three rotating backups, CINEside keeps two longer-lived safety copies in the same folder, which are not affected by the regular rotation:

- One backup per work hour (hourly-YYYY-MM-DD-HH.cnsd), taken before the first save of that hour and never overwritten within the hour. Hourly backups are kept for the last 12 hours you worked on the project.
- One backup per day (daily-YYYY-MM-DD.cnsd), taken before your first save of that day - so you always have a copy from before today's changes, even after many saves since. Daily backups are kept for the last 14 days you actually worked on the project.
- One backup before every script re-import (before-import-<date>_<time>.cnsd) - re-importing a revised script is the single action most likely to affect many scenes at once, so it gets its own permanent safety copy right beforehand.
- One backup before every restore (before-restore-...) and before replacing a project on import or Save As (before-replace-...).

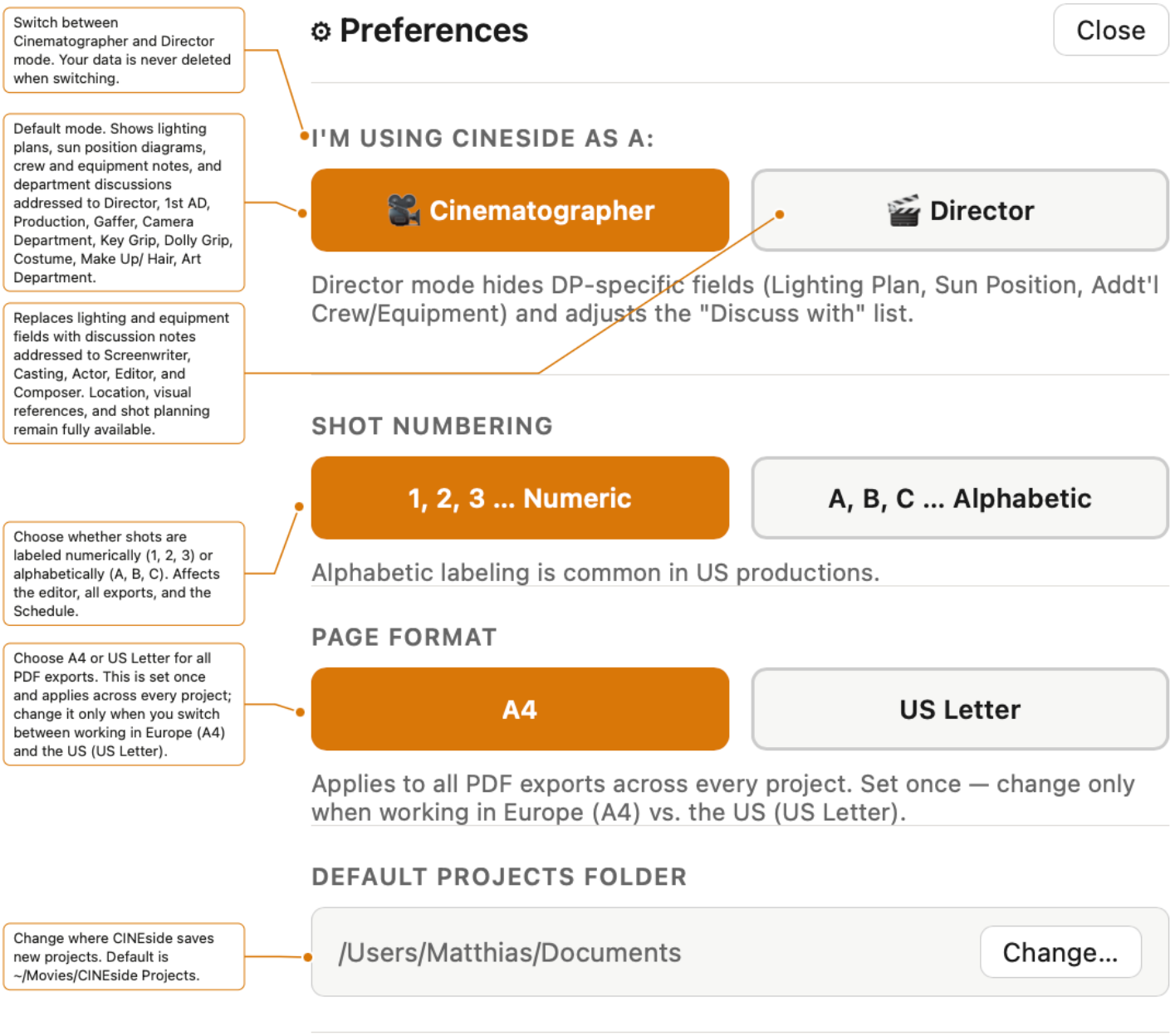
This gives a staggered restore timeline: the three recent saves (last ~15 minutes) → hourly anchors (last 12 hours) → daily anchors (last 14 days).
If a project file is ever unreadable, CINEside opens the most recent backup automatically. To view the backups in Finder, press Cmd+Shift+. to show hidden files.

11.3 Restoring a Backup

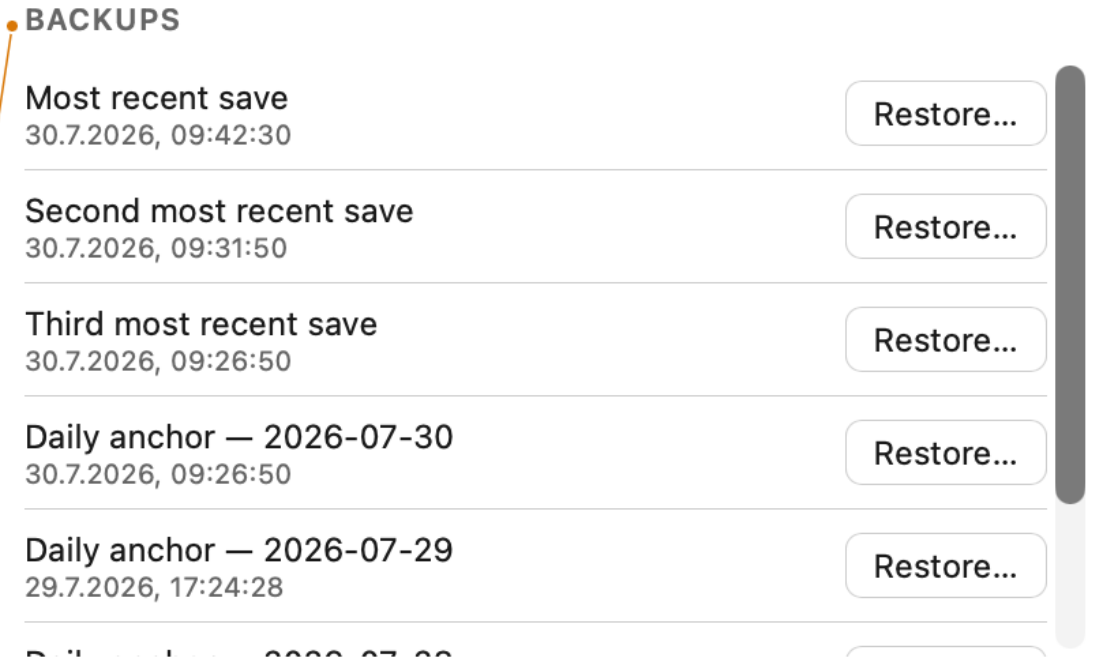
In Preferences → Backups, CINEside lists every available restore point with its date and time. Safety copies (Before import, Before restore, Before replace) are listed first, followed by the recent saves, hourly and daily anchors. Click Restore... next to the one you want and confirm.
Before restoring, CINEside saves your current state as a "Before restore" copy. The restored version is loaded into the editor, and nothing is written to your project file - not even by the automatic save - until you save yourself. If the restored version isn't what you wanted, restore testore" copy or reopen the project without saving. Photos needed by the restored version are brought back automatically.

11.4 License

Your license key can be active on up to three devices at once. If you're replacing or selling one of your devices, click Deactivate This Device in Preferences before doing so. This frees up a slot on your license key so you can activate CINEside on your next device. After deactivating, CINEside returns to Demo Mode on this device until you enter your license key again.
Direct download: enter your license key again. App Store version: sign in with your Apple ID and use Restore Purchases.

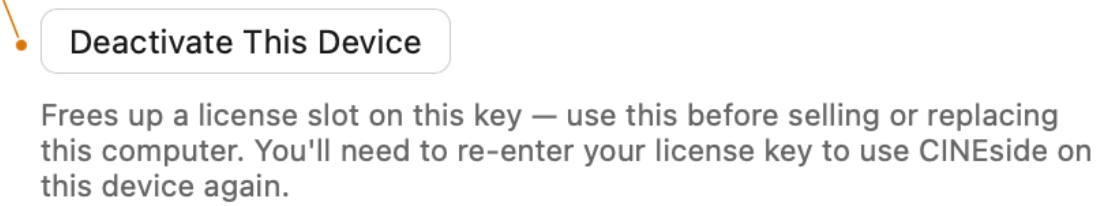

Switch between Cinematographer and Director mode. Your data is never deleted when switching.
Default mode. Shows lighting plans, sun position diagrams, crew and equipment notes, and department discussions addressed to Director, 1st AD, Production, Gaffer, Camera Department, Key Grip, Dolly Grip, Costume, Make Up/ Hair, Art Department.
Replaces lighting and equipment fields with discussion notes addressed to Screenwriter, Casting, Actor, Editor, and Composer. Location, visual references, and shot planning remain fully available.
Choose whether shots are labeled numerically (1, 2, 3) or alphabetically (A, B, C). Affects the editor, all exports, and the Schedule.
Choose A4 or US Letter for all PDF exports. This is set once and applies across every project; change it only when you switch between working in Europe (A4) and the US (US Letter).
Change where CINEside saves new projects. Default is ~/Movies/CINEside Projects.
⚙ Preferences
Close
I'M USING CINESIDE AS A:
Cinematographer
Director
Director mode hides DP-specific fields (Lighting Plan, Sun Position, Addt'l Crew/Equipment) and adjusts the "Discuss with" list.
SHOT NUMBERING
1, 2, 3 ... Numeric
A, B, C ... Alphabetic
Alphabetic labeling is common in US productions.
PAGE FORMAT
A4
US Letter
Applies to all PDF exports across every project. Set once — change only when working in Europe (A4) vs. the US (US Letter).
DEFAULT PROJECTS FOLDER
/Users/Matthias/Documents
Change...

CINEside lists every available restore point — the three recent saves, the daily anchors, and the pre-import safety copies — each with its date and time. Click Restore... next to the one you want; CINEside asks you to confirm, then loads that version into the editor.
Restoring only changes what's shown on screen — nothing is written to disk until you save. If the restored version isn't what you wanted, simply reopen the project without saving to get back to where you were.



Restoring loads a backup into the editor — nothing is written to disk until you save. Daily backups are kept for the last 14 times you worked on this project.

Your license key can be active on up to three devices at once. If you're replacing or selling one of your devices, click Deactivate This Device in Preferences before doing so. This frees up a slot on your license key so you can activate CINEside on your next device. After deactivating, CINEside returns to Demo Mode on this device until you enter your license key again.



Frees up a license slot on this key — use this before selling or replacing this computer. You'll need to re-enter your license key to use CINEside on this device again.

12 Saving & Project Management

12.1 Saving

Press Cmd+S or click Save to save your project. The first time, CINEside asks for a project name and creates a self-contained folder:

```
MyFilm/
MyFilm.cnsd      - your project file
photos/          - all reference images
photos/.unused/  - photos that are no longer used anywhere in the project or its backups. CINEside moves them here instead of deleting them; Undo and Restore bring
                   them back automatically.
.backups/        - automatic backups (hidden)
```

> On iPad: the same .cnsd structure is used, but it lives inside the app's storage area in the fixed CINEside Projects folder. Reopen projects from the recent list (see 12.2), not the Files app.

! Always keep the entire project folder together. The photos/ folder is required - the .cnsd file alone is not sufficient.

See 11.2 – 11.3 for how automatic backups work and how to restore one.

Save As (saving to a new location)
Use Save As to write the project to a different folder - for example onto an external drive or into a new location. CINEside copies the project's reference photos into the new folder as well, so the copy is complete and self-contained; the original stays untouched.

Save As suggests the current project name and folder. If you replace an existing project, its previous version is kept as a "Before replace" backup.

If a project already exists at the chosen location, CINEside asks before replacing it (Replace existing project?). Choose Cancel to keep the existing project, or Replace to overwrite it. Re-saving your current project to its own folder does not ask.

CINEside will not save a project inside another project's folder; if you pick one by mistake, it tells you and nothing is written.

12.2 Recent Projects

CINEside keeps a list of recently opened projects. Double-clicking a .cnsd file in Finder also opens the project directly.
Whenever you open a different project - from the recent list, via Open, from Finder, or by importing a .cnsf - and the current project has unsaved changes, CINEside asks first and names the file that would be saved. If saving fails, the other project is not opened.

12.3 Closing a Project

Click Close in the toolbar. If there are unsaved changes, CINEside asks whether to save before closing.
If saving cannot complete or you cancel it, the project stays open and your changes are kept - nothing is discarded.

13 Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
`Cmd+S`	Save project
`Cmd+Z`	Undo last change
`← →  (Arrow keys)`	Navigate to previous / next scene (when not typing in a field)
`N`	Next unreviewed CONNECT note (when note navigation is active)
`P`	Previous unreviewed CONNECT note
`Enter`	Next script search result
`Shift+Enter`	Previous script search result
`Cmd+Q`	Quit CINEside

> Keyboard shortcuts apply on iPad only when an external keyboard is connected.

14 CINEside CONNECT

CINEside CONNECT is a separate free application.
It opens .cnct packages in read-only mode, adds annotations, and exports a .cnsn notes file or a PDF.

This chapter covers what a CINEside user needs to know; the full CONNECT manual is at:
cineside.app/downloads/CINEside_CONNECT_User_Manual.pdf

14.1 Opening a Package

Double-click (or tap) a .cnct file to open it in CINEside CONNECT, or launch CONNECT and use the Open button.
The package is self-contained - no connection to the original project folder is required.

14.2 Navigating

Use the scene navigation at the top to move between scenes. The layout mirrors CINEside: shots on the left, script on the right.
The script column shows each shot as a coloured line in its own lane, labelled with the shot number. A number row at the top lists the shots of the current scene, and a small box marks the first line of each shot. Passages marked Not in frame are drawn pale and dashed. Click or tap a box or a number to open that shot.

> On iPad, the note field stays visible above the keyboard while you type.

14.3 Adding Notes

Shot notes	Click or tap the note field below any shot and type your annotation.
Script passage notes	Select text in the script. A toolbar appears - clic/ tapk + Note to add an annotation linked to that passage.
Image notes	Click/ tap any reference image to open it larger. A note field appears below the enlarged image.

14.4 Exporting

CINEside CONNECT offers two exports:

Export Notes	Creates a .cnsn file containing only your annotations. Send this back to the CINEside user for import.
Export PDF	Creates a PDF of the shooting script - useful for printing or distributing the script.

The CONNECT PDF has a hole-punch margin on both sides. Each shot line carries its colour and number in a label box.
A gap in a shot (Not in frame) is drawn as a zigzag.

14.5 Limitations

CINEside CONNECT is read-only with one exception: notes. You cannot add shots, edit scene information, or otherwise modify the project - but you can add notes to shots, script passages, and images (see 14.3), which are then sent back to the CINEside user as a .cnsn file.
CINEside CONNECT works completely offline - nothing is uploaded or transmitted.

15 File Format Reference

.cnsd 	Your CINEside project. A folder containing the project file, a photos/ subfolder, and a .backups/ subfolder. Always keep all three together when moving or archiving. Double-click the .cnsd file inside the folder to open the project.
.cnct	CONNECT package. A single self-contained file with the complete shooting script and all reference images. Read-only - the recipient can annotate but not edit the project.
.cnsn 	Notes file from CINEside CONNECT. Contains only annotations - no project data, no images. Import by double-clicking.
.cnsf  	Share package. A single self-contained file containing the full project and all reference photos - the easiest way to hand off a fully editable project to a collaborator or to move a project between your own devices. Sending the .cnsd project folder directly would require manually zipping it including the photos/ subfolder; .cnsf handles that automatically, and - for the Director and Cinematographer variants (10.2, 10.3) - strips the other role's private notes. The Full variant (10.1) is a 1:1 copy and keeps everything. The recipient opens it in CINEside, chooses a name and save location, and it becomes a normal editable project on their machine.

16 Support

Questions, feedback, and bug reports: info@cineside.app
Every message is read personally.
Website: cineside.app
Getting Started guide: cineside.app/getting-started.html
CINEside on the App Store (Mac + iPad): apps.apple.com/app/cineside-shot-list-script/id6791491272
CINEside CONNECT on the App Store (Mac + iPad): apps.apple.com/app/cineside-connect/id6793694166

© 2026 Matthias Grunsky · CINEside